

'celebrating diversity' - Diversity Works Conference 2004



Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle & Hunter Region Ltd

2004 ANNUAL GENERAL REPORT

ACN: 002 898 759
ABN: 72 002 898 759
MRCNH@MRCNH.ORG

8 CHAUCER STREET
HAMILTON NSW 2303
WWW.MRCNH.ORG

PH: (02) 49693399
FAX: (02) 49614997
FREECALL: 1800 813 205

**Our 2004 front page features images from the very successful
Diversity Works Conference, which the Centre hosted in May 2004**

The Conference was originally planned as part of the work program of the
Productive Diversity in the Workplace Program, funded by the
Department of Education and Training,
and had entailed significant planning tasks,
including securing the sponsorships necessary to host the event,
to secure entries and present awards.

A most dedicated and supportive Committee comprising representatives of
Australian Business Limited, and other private enterprise agents,
the Hunter Area Consultative Committee, and Premier's Department.

At the 11th hour,
the Department axed the Program
and expected us to axe the Conference.

We did not.

In our view, more than our credibility was at stake: we needed to keep faith
with all the wonderful people who had taken part on our planning journey,
and we could not leave unsung the amazing contribution
of our skilled migrants to the economic,
social and cultural life of Regional NSW.

So we are delighted to report that our Conference
proceeded and succeeded with flying colours.

Our sponsors remained with us,
our speakers were luminous
and our award winners were simply awesome.

There was only one loser.



ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING 2004

TABLE OF CONTENTS

PAGE	ITEM
2	AGENDA
3	MRC MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE & STAFF 2004
4-5	MINUTES OF 18TH ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING 2003
6	2003 ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING ATTENDANCE LIST
7	MRC PURPOSES & OBJECTIVES
8	MRC SERVICE PRINCIPLES
9	OVERVIEW OF MRC
10	MRC REGIONS
11-12	CHAIRMAN'S REPORT
13-14	DIRECTOR'S REPORT
15-16	COMMUNITY PROJECT OFFICER
17-18	COMMUNITY SETTLEMENT SERVICES SCHEME I RURAL SUPPORT WORKER
19-20	COMMUNITY SETTLEMENT SERVICES SCHEME II WELFARE WORKER – OUTREACH
21-22	REFUGEE AND HUMANITARIAN ENTRANT WORKER
23-24	SUDANESE & AFRICAN COMMUNITIES SUPPORT WORKER
25	PHOTOS OF AUSTCARE REFUGEE WEEK CELEBRATIONS
26	SKILLED MIGRANT PLACEMENT OFFICER
27-28	PRODUCTIVE DIVERSITY IN THE WORKPLACE
29-30	FILIPINO WELFARE WORKER
31-32	MULTICULTURAL FAMILY SUPPORT (FAMILIES FIRST) PROJECT
33-34	COMMUNITY AGED CARE PACKAGES PROJECT
35-36	COMMUNITY VISITOR SCHEME
37-38	MULTICULTURAL FAMILY SUPPORT WORKER
39-40	COMMUNITY SETTLEMENT SERVICES SCHEME NEW ENGLAND PROJECT
41	CENTRE USAGE 2004
42	OTHER MRC STAFF MEMBERS
	AUDITOR'S REPORT CUTCHER & NEALE CHARTERED ACCOUNTANTS pp. 1-22



MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE

OF NEWCASTLE & HUNTER REGION LTD

A C N 002 898 759 / A B N 72 002 898 759

Phone :0249 693399
Free Call: 1800 813 205
Fax: 0249 614997
Email: mrcnh@mrcnh.org
Website www.mrcnh.org

8 Chaucer Street
Hamilton NSW 2303

NOTICE IS HEREBY GIVEN OF THE 19TH ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING
OF THE MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE
TO BE HELD ON WEDNESDAY 17 NOVEMBER 2004
AT 8 CHAUCER STREET HAMILTON
AT 11.00AM

1. OPENING & WELCOME BY
CHAIRMAN, MR HENRY CHAN
2. APOLOGIES
3. MINUTES OF 2003 AGM
4. BUSINESS ARISING
5. PRESENTATION OF REPORTS
6. CONFIRMATION OF AUDITORS
7. ELECTION OF MRC
MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE
8. GENERAL BUSINESS
9. CLOSE & LIGHT REFRESHMENTS

GUEST SPEAKER
MR JIM O CALLAGHAN
STATE DIRECTOR
DEPARTMENT OF IMMIGRATION &
MULTICULTURAL & INDIGENOUS AFFAIRS

MRC MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE MEMBERS 2003-2004

- | | |
|------------------------|-------------------------|
| 1. Chairperson | - Henry H Chan |
| 2. Vice Chairperson | - William Simanowsky |
| 3. Treasurer | - Paul Mather |
| 4. Asst Treasurer | - Trudy Mills Evers |
| 5. Secretary | - Alina Kizeweter |
| 6. Assistant Secretary | - Sania Young |
| 6. Member | - Zoran Vasiljevic |
| 7. Member | - Ivan Klopčic |
| 9. Member | - Fthir Nicholas Zervas |
| 10. Member | - Andrea Rufo |

COOPTED MEMBERS

- | | |
|---|-----------------------------------|
| 1. Department of Immigration & Multicultural & Indigenous Affairs | - Ms Deborah Carr / Mr Tim Morgan |
| 2. Newcastle City Council | - Cr Barbara Gaudry |

STAFF

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1. Director | - Violetta Walsh |
| 2. Asst Director / Migration Agent | - Lulu Tantos |
| 3. Migration Agent / Community Project Officer | - Irina Lupish |
| 4. Financial Controller | - Arlene Richards |
| 5. Office Manager | - Mary Milevski |
| 6. Administrative Officers | - Carla Silva / Annie Gawn |
| 7. Community Development Worker CSSS: Level III | - Alex Burns |
| 8. Community Welfare Worker CSSS: Level II | - Miza Torlakovic |
| 9. African refugee Settlement Scheme Worker | - Simon Major Pabek |
| 10. Productive Diversity In the Workplace - Program Coordinator – till 30/06/04 | |
| Living In Harmony Project Coordinator | - Cathy Johnston |
| 11. Special Migrant Placement Officer – till 30/06/04 | |
| Refugee Employment Support Officer | - Christine Follett |
| 12. Filipino Welfare Worker | - Petrona Kelly |
| 13. Family Support Worker | - Hakim Makem / Juanita Loli |
| 14. Multicultural Family Worker | - Devika Wijewardene |
| 15. Community Visitor's Program | - Johanna Dupree |
| 16. Community Aged Care Package Coordinators | - Sue Hristov / Teleisia Lolohea |
| 17. Citizenship Support Officer | - Annie Gawn |
| 18. Problem Gambling Support Project- till 30/04/04 | - Lisa Reardon |
| 19. IHSS Refugee Worker | - Tima Oto |
| 20. IHSS Assistants | - Agnes Oto / Robyn Graham / Ross Leonard |
| 21. IT Consultant | - Daniel Follett |

SESSIONAL STAFF

- | | |
|--|---------------------------------|
| 1. Pacific Islander Welfare Worker (Samoan) | - Juanita Loli |
| 2. Pacific Islander Welfare Worker (Tongan) | - Teleisia Lolohea / Lupe Fonua |
| 3. Hunter Ethnic Parents Teachers Association Of Community Language Schools –Project Officer | - Michael O'Sullivan |
| 4. Skillmax Coordinator | - Kathy Patterson |
| 5. Seniors IT Coordinator | - Daniel Follett |
| 6. Administration Officer (casual) | - Mark Whit |

**MINUTES OF THE 18^H ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING OF THE MIGRANT
RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION LTD, HELD AT
THE MRC PREMISES ON WEDNESDAY 19TH NOVEMBER 2003 AT 11AM**

PRESENT: As per list attached

1. H Chan welcomed everyone present on behalf of the MRC Management Committee.
2. **APOLOGIES:** Pet Kelly, T Lolohea, A Burns, D Wijewardene, C Silva & M Sutcliffe.
3. **MINUTES OF THE 2002 AGM**
Proposer: T Mills-Evers
Seconder: Fr N Zervas
4. **BUSINESS ARISING:**
DIMIA Client Access Project is continuing
5. **PRESENTATION OF REPORTS**
 - (i) **Chairperson's Report** –H Chan presented his report. It is his 13th year as Chairperson.
 - (ii) **V Walsh –Director:** Report tabled and accepted as read:
Violetta stated that there are about 70-100 people of Sudanese people residing in Newcastle, and under the IHSS (Integrated Humanitarian Settlement Service) a further 70 people are expected to arrive in early 2004. Much work must be done to help the new arrivals settle, and they are a high needs group.
 - (iii) **I Lupish – CPO:** Report tabled and accepted as read.
 - (iv) **A Burns: Community Settlement Services I:** Report tabled and accepted as read
 - (v) **Miza Torlakovic – Community Settlement Services II:** Report tabled and accepted as read
 - (vi) **P Dring – Families First Access and Equity:** Report tabled and accepted as read. Pat added that she was delighted to be back for this short period.
 - (vii) **Christine Follett – SMPO:** Report tabled and accepted as read. Christine Follett added that the targets set by the Department of Education have been met.
 - (viii) **Lisa Reardon – Problem Gambling Project** – Report tabled and accepted as read. Her group work is ongoing. Wish to thank staff and committee for their support.
 - (ix) **Lisa Reardon on behalf of Marcela Sutcliffe– Family Welfare Support Worker** - Report tabled and accepted as read. Marcela is still on sick leave.
 - (x) **P Kelly – Filipino Welfare Support Worker** - Report tabled and accepted as read
 - (xi) **C Johnston – Rural Information Officer** - Report tabled and accepted as read. Thanked staff and committee for their support in the last 12 months.
 - (xii) **A Dupree – Community Volunteer Scheme** - Report tabled and accepted as read. She commented on one of her clients, (Mr Grezl) who is in a home – he

was a tireless worker for migrants when he first arrived as a refugee 50 years ago.

(xiii) **Community Aged Care Package – Sue Hristov and Sulu Lolohea** - Report tabled and accepted as read. Thanked staff and committee for their support.

(xiv) **Carla Silva – Youth Worker** – Report tabled and accepted as read.

Reports accepted

Proposer: Zoran Vasiljevic

Seconded: Sania Young

6. FINANCIAL REPORTS: Paul Mather presented these on behalf of the Committee

- (i) Trudy Mills-Evers complimented Violetta on the day to day management of the Centre.
- (ii) H Chan thanked Paul Mather for his advice and expertise on the Centre's finances.

Proposer: Ivan Klopčic

Seconded: Alina Kizeweter

7. APPOINTMENT OF COMPANY AUDITORS:

Henry Chan moved that Cutcher and Neal be retained as the Centre's Auditor, accepted by PMather.

**8. Election of the MRC management.
(10 nominations for 11 positions)**

- 1. B Simanowsky
- 2. Sania Young
- 3. Ivan Klopčic
- 4. Alina Kizeweter
- 5. Trudy Mills-Evers
- 6. Zoran Vasiljevic
- 7. Father Nicholas Zervas
- 8. Andrea Rufo
- 9. H Chan
- 10. Paul Mather

The 10 nominees were duly elected as the 2004 management committee.

10. GENERAL BUSINESS:

- (i) B Simanowsky thanked staff for their assistance at all times.
- (ii) H Chan thanked Violetta and staff for their hard work in trying to run the Centre and its diverse needs and at the same time seeking funding.
- (iii) Violetta welcomed Mary Milevski as the new face of the Centre.
- (iv) Application for CSSS funding for the New England area has been successful.
- (v) The Centre is assisting proposed refugees and their proposers, as required.

**11. Guest Speaker – THE HON LAURIE FERGUSON
Shadow Minister for Citizenship & Multicultural Affairs**

MEETING ENDED AT 12.30 PM.
NEXT ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING TO BE HELD ON
WEDNESDAY 17TH NOVEMBER 2004 AT 11.00AM

**MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE OF THE MRC ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING
HELD ON 19TH NOVEMBER 2003**

	NAME	COMMUNITY		NAME	COMMUNITY
1.	Miza Torlakovic	MRC	2.	Dubravka Vasiljevic	Bosnian
3.	Lidija Baloevic	Bosnian	4.	Zoran Vasiljevic	Bosnian
5.	Bill Simanowsky	Ukrainian	6.	Savela Delic	Bosnian
7.	Lorraine Norton	CRC	8.	Paul Mather	Board Member
9..	Deborah Carr	DIMIA	10.	Victor Lupish	Russian
11.	Trudy-Mills Evers	MRC	12.	Sonia Lundqvist-Gibson	Ethnic HACC
13.	Rachele Dos Santos	Italian	14.	Mary Cady	Maycare Mult Group
15.	Douglas Cady	Maycare Mult Group	16.	Laurie Ferguson	Shadow Minister for DIMIA
17.	Nino Alofonso	Skillmax	18.	Kelematina Purcell	Samoa
19.	Carrie Ferguson	Skillmax	20.	Mae Reid	Skillmax
21.	Sania Young	Russian	22.	Henry Chan	Chinese
23.	Diana Dolan	Filipino	24.	Ivan Klopccic	Slovene
25.	Fr N Zervas	Greek	26.	Luigi Adlan	Sudanese
27.	Charles Bak	Sudanese	28.	Teresa Losurdo	Spanish
29.	Elizabeth Lusurdo	TAFE student placement	30.	Cathy Johnston	MRC
31.	Arlene Richards	MRC	32.	Annie Gawn	MRC
33.	Sue Hristov	MRC	34.	Michael O'Sullivan	HEPTACLS
35.	Alina Kizeweter	Polish	36.	Denise Hodgson	Centrelink
37.	Irena Lupish	Russian	38.	Zhaoria Yan	Skillmax
39.	Chris Follett	MRC	40.	Juanita Loli	MRC
41.	Tima Oto	MRC	42.	Andrea Rufo	Italian
43.	Elina Simunovic	Tongan	44.	Michael Todd	Macedonian
45.	Robert Bell	FASHVI	46.	Juanita Loli	PIWC/Samoan
47.	Lani Larsen	Filipino	48.	Violetta Walsh	MRC
49.	Mary Milevski	MRC	50.	Pat Dring	MRC
51.	Lisa Reardon	MRC			



MRC 2004 ...celebrating diversity

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE

OF NEWCASTLE & HUNTER REGION LIMITED

PURPOSES

- **The MRC of Newcastle and Hunter Region Ltd is a community based not for profit organization, which has operated in the Newcastle area since its establishment by the Federal Government in 1981.**
- **The MRC's mission is to strive for the successful integration of migrants in the Hunter and outreach locations identified by the Rural Strategy of the Department of Immigration and Multicultural Affairs', being the North, North West, Central West and Central Coast of NSW.**

MRC OBJECTIVES

- **To deliver high quality settlement services to target group**
- **To focus on service delivery for special needs groups – refugee/humanitarian entrants, newly arrived, unemployed, aged, young people and women.**
- **To promote an environment of mutual understanding between the mainstream and ethnic communities.**
- **To provide outreach services to people of non-English Speaking Background residing in isolated and rural areas.**

Service Principles

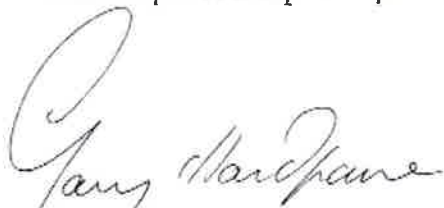
The Hon Gary Hardgrave MP, Minister for Citizenship and Multicultural Affairs, is committed to ensuring that Migrant Resource Centres/Migrant Service Agencies provide the highest quality service, and maintain a focus on client needs.

This is supported by the *Newcastle and Hunter Region Migrant Resource Centre*.

The Minister and the *Newcastle and Hunter Region Migrant Resource Centre* endorse the following principles, which must guide the provision of quality programs and services:

1. Newly arrived migrants must have equal opportunity to realise their full potential and must have access to appropriate programs and services;
2. Every person should be able to maintain his or her culture without prejudice or disadvantage and should be encouraged to understand and embrace other cultures;
3. Needs of migrants should, in general, be met by programs and services available to the whole community but special services and programs may be necessary to ensure equality of access and provision; and
4. Services and programs should be designed and operated in full consultation with clients, and self-help should be encouraged as much as possible with a view to helping migrants to become self-reliant quickly.

The Minister and *Newcastle and Hunter Region Migrant Resource Centre* will work in partnership to implement this commitment.


Gary Hardgrave
Minister for Citizenship and
Multicultural Affairs

Date: 6/6/2002


(HENRY CHEN)
Chairperson of
*Newcastle and Hunter Region Migrant
Resource Centre*
Date: 06/06/2002

Funded Partnerships throughout 2004

Department of Immigration Multicultural and Indigenous Affairs

NSW Department of Community Services

NSW Department of Education and Training (till June 2004)

Commonwealth Department of Health and Ageing

Casino Benefit Fund, NSW Dept of Gaming and Racing (till April 2004)

Community Relations Commission for a Multicultural NSW

NSW Department of Ageing, Disability and Home Care

• **Clients of MRC, by Ethnic Background**

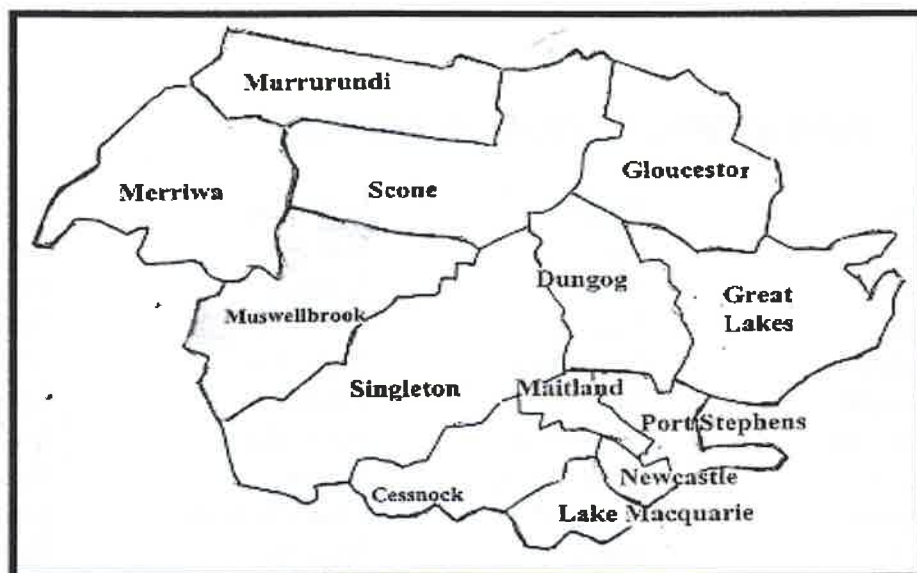
Albania	Egypt	Malaysia	Scotland
Algeria	Fiji	Macedonia	Serbia
Australia	Finland	Mexico	Singapore
Austria	France	Montenegro	Slovenia
Argentina	Germany	Morocco	South Africa
Azerbaijan	Greece	Mauritius	Spain
Bangladesh	Honduras	Netherlands	Sri Lanka
Belgium	Hong Kong	Nepal	Sudan
Botswana	Hungary	New Zealand	Sweden
Bosnia	India	Nigeria	Switzerland
Brazil	Indonesia	Norway	Syria
Canada	Ireland	Panama	Tahiti
Chile	Iran	Pakistan	Taiwan
China	Italy	Papua New Guinea	Thailand
Colombia	Japan	Paraguay	Tonga
Costa Rica	Jordan	Persia	Tunisia
Croatia	Kazakhstan	Peru	Turkey
Cyprus	Kenya	Poland	Ukraine
Czech Republic	Korea	Portugal	Uruguay
Dominican Republic	Kuwait	The Philippines	USA
East Timor	Latvia	Romania	Venezuela
England	Lebanon	Russia	Vietnam
El Salvador	Lithuania	Samoa	



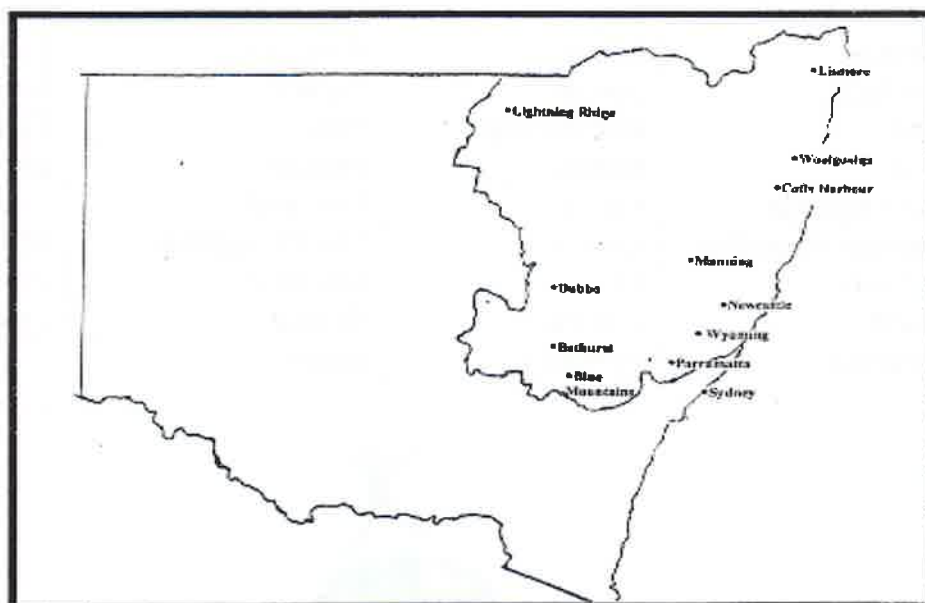
MRC 2004 ...celebrating diversity

OUR REGIONS

HUNTER AREA



RURAL STRATEGY AREA





Chairman's Report

This has been quite a year for all of us at the MRC- a year of great challenge, of great effort, of innovation, of success, but as always in our sector, some uncertainty and disappointment.

But as the year rushes to its close, we can look back with quiet satisfaction on work well done. We have surpassed our goals, we have expanded our services and our geographic horizons, and we have balanced our books. In the language of the corporate sector, which sadly, we seem more and more obliged to use, we can say with every confidence that we have kept our "shareholders" very happy indeed.

Time will allow only a brief snapshot of our performance, so I will choose just some of the highlights which account for our time and the expenditure of the public resources which underwrite them.

There is no doubt that our greatest challenge this year has been the resettlement of the African refugees who have arrived in this area in unprecedented numbers. We believe we now have the largest refugee community outside the Sydney metropolitan area- a contingent that has grown from just a single family of four in mid 2002 to over 500 people today. And if there is any certainty in this world, it is that these numbers will grow, continuing to face awesome barriers to settlement that are challenging service providers in the region.

Our heartfelt sympathy goes to these cruelly displaced people- a sympathy reflected in the generous responses throughout the mainstream community, without whose support the tasks would be insurmountable. The provision of a refugee worker in July by DIMIA is much appreciated, but there is a compelling case for increasing resources to more effectively do the job at hand.

Last year I reported of the Centre's expansion into the New England area offering services to new arrivals in Armidale and surrounding centres; our service there is now full time, well established and well received by the communities resident there. This year, I am pleased to report that we are heading south. A recent successful tender to the Department of Ageing, Disability and Home Care will allow us to establish and develop migrant aged services on the Central Coast, and we look forward to a most collaborative association with our new funding partner to deliver much needed support services to a group who have been neglected too long in Australia, having arrived long before the notion of settlement services was even conceived.

It pleases us that through this most exciting and innovative program, we can offer a balance in our service delivery – to the vulnerable long time settlers, as well as to the vulnerable newly arrived.

Innovation and this Centre are of course not strangers. We have not been afraid to move into uncharted waters to meet identified needs-always in the context of the most careful risk assessment. Earlier this year we moved to providing migration services on a cost recovery basis to cater for the continuous stream of requests for immigration advice and assistance from clients ineligible for the free services which we are able to offer, courtesy of a successful tender to the Department of Immigration. Such clients include overseas students, business migrants, and employers seeking skilled workers. Our venture has been a resounding success: our fees are modest, our service is skilled, efficient and accessible.

There are many other examples of the energy and the vigilance of the Centre in identifying and winning opportunities to enhance the lives and the welfare of our many clients, and to continue to raise awareness of the changing needs of our migrant and refugee population. They will be found throughout the reports within this booklet.

But I cannot conclude my own report without expressing once again the disappointment we continue to feel about the arbitrary termination by the state of two magnificent programs, the Skilled Migrant Placement and the Productive Diversity in the Workplace, which, so long and successfully, had facilitated employment opportunity for skilled migrants to this Region. We made no secret of the fact that we found the state's actions unforgettably mean-spirited and frankly hypocritical. We have all heard the constant calls from Macquarie St "to get migrants out of Sydney"- and yet we see the dismantling of the single scrap of infrastructure to help keep them here. We feel the loss of these Programs keenly, and will not rest till substitutes can be found.

As I said earlier, a challenging year indeed, culminating in the "race that stopped the nation," or more accurately perhaps, stultified the nation.

I wonder if anyone else noticed that throughout the dozens of policies announced by the political parties in the period leading up to that "race" there was not a single mention of a policy of multiculturalism. Not a blip on anyone's radar. And I suppose that can be interpreted in a number of ways: that there is total bipartisan agreement on multicultural policy; that there were no votes in putting forward such policies; that multiculturalism is yesterday's issue, and has no place in the vision that parties put forward for the Australia of tomorrow. But it would have been nice to get a mention!

Perhaps we should console ourselves with some concrete indications. The Multicultural portfolio lives on. We have a new Minister for Citizenship and Multicultural Affairs, the Hon Peter McGauren, and we look forward to working with him as we did with his predecessor. We can still count DIMIA as one of our major funding bodies, supporting this agency and many of its projects, with little sign of diminution.

Perhaps there is a degree of safety in not being controversial.

Finally, I want to take this opportunity to pay tribute to my fellow Board members, whose dedication to this Centre and its work knows no bounds. I have personally greatly valued their support, and as the years have rolled on, their friendship.

And of course, our collective thanks to our staff who are extraordinarily capable, and committed to the splendid work of this Centre.

My sincere thanks to you all.

Henry Chan



Director's Report 2004

This has been such a milestone year for me.

The first important date was the 9th April which marked the 20th anniversary of my association with the Centre, an almost continuous association apart from a twelve month secondment to a state government department for a particular project. I do believe that makes me the longest serving MRC Coordinator in the country- and I'm not sure if that's a badge of pride or

cause for embarrassment. Such length of time in one job can signify laziness, mediocrity, and lack of ambition, at best lack of opportunity. From my point of view it is most definitely a testament to survival in a industry sector not generally known for its stability, let alone longevity. But here I am, still standing, twenty years older and wiser and busier than ever before.

As alluded to by our Chairman, we have been quite frantically busy with the settlement of refugee and Humanitarian entrants, the largest such group to this area in my living memory. They are from Africa, currently the major source continent for Australia's refugee intake, predominantly Sudanese, but also Liberian. There do not seem to be many parts of Africa free from strife and turmoil.

Both Government sponsored and community proposed arrivals have been coming in what seems like a stream, and most have come through the doors of this Centre. The settlement needs of this group are simply enormous. Apart from their traumatic pre-migration circumstances, they must now adapt to our vastly different western urban society, with a new language, and a very unfamiliar cultural environment.

We are just holding up, thanks to the amazing support coming from volunteers from all walks of life in this city, whose generosity knows no bounds. The real challenge is to ensure that the sense of compassion and welcome continues, as the numbers continue to grow, and much of this depends on the self-help networks that the African community itself develops. It is our job to assist in this process as much as to deliver direct settlement services.

Our partnership with a variety of funding bodies has continued, strong, and productive. The NSW Department of Education and Training, (our funding body for the Special Migrant Placement Program, and the Productive Diversity in the Workplace) has gone alas, but new doors have opened. Through successful submissions, we have forged new and exciting relationships with Department of Ageing, Disability and Home Care which will allow us to develop some much needed services for frail aged migrants and their carers, providing personal care as well as dementia respite. Together with our Community Visitors Scheme, and the Community Aged Care Packages, funded through the Federal Department of Health and Ageing, we will be able to provide a more comprehensive range of support for those who have been overlooked during their long years in Australia, not only here in the Hunter but on the Central Coast as well.

It is so rewarding to offer services to this target group. For example, we have been running IT courses for Seniors, thanks to funding from that same Department, and have been greatly cheered by the enthusiasm and appreciation of our more mature age students. These courses will keep running well into the New Year.

Our relationship with DIMIA has not yet changed, as we were fully expecting last year. We remain for the moment "their" funded service, and at this stage would not expect a call for tender by the Department in time for the financial year start of July 2005. There is nothing more to report on the combined grants proposal either, which would have entailed bidding for significant dollars representing the pooled costs of MRC and CSSS. In this constantly changing world, a degree of comfort is to be relished from a bit of "business as usual."

However the new tenders for the Integrated Humanitarian Settlement Strategy (IHSS) to commence in October 2005, are invited and are being hotly contested. We are happy to say there has been much service streamlining and improvement in the new tenders on offer, but only 3 contracts will be allocated across the whole state. Regrettably, we are not in a position to bid in our own right, as geographically we are included in the northern metropolitan section of the state; but we are most anxious to be part of a successful tender. We cannot provide any immediate post arrival services to refugees and humanitarian entrants if we are not contracted to do so- or we can, but we would not be funded for it. And clearly, this area will continue to attract more and more settlement by the refugee arrivals, proposed by those already here.

All in all, we continue to cooperate well with "our" Department. We are pleased for example, to host the regular visits of DIMIA officers who come to provide face to face immigration services to clients in the region: we are part of the Department's Community Access project, which allows clients here direct access to migration information and forms; and we are now able to assist people with the preparation and lodgement of Citizenship applications. While still a Pilot, we have been very happy with the take-up of this service locally.

One of the most difficult aspects about working in this sector is that projects end, sometimes unexpectedly, and we have to say goodbye to the most wonderful staff members any agency could want. But we keep good people in our sights. Lisa Reardon (our Casino Benefit Fund worker) is still busy enjoying motherhood, but I am happy to say that both Cathy Johnston, and Chris Follett, who were involved in the programs axed by the state, are now back with us, continuing to make an outstanding contribution in other areas of our work. Cathy is involved in implementing our Living in Harmony project, (newly granted by the Department of Immigration) and Chris is currently facilitating employment pathways for the African refugees. We have not lost their skills, their dedication and their wonderful company. And we have gained new resources to assist us in the refugee work - Simon Pabek commenced in July as our full time African refugee worker, and Hakim Makem, in a part time support role. They have one of the most difficult and thankless jobs in the sector, providing services to their own community.

I said I had 2 personal milestones to report. The second, quite unforgettable milestone took place on 23rd January, at a gala lunch, when I was named Newcastle's Citizen of the Year 2004. Do you know it is possible to feel 6 inches high, and ten feet tall both at the same time? It was a wonderful acknowledgement by this city and I will treasure it always.

As always I extend my heartfelt gratitude to the Centre's Board, which is legendary in its loyalty and dedication, and to the wonderful staff who give me such support and dedication.

Violetta Walsh

COMMUNITY PROJECT OFFICER – 2004 ANNUAL REPORT

(Funded by the Department of Immigration & Multicultural & Indigenous Affairs)



Community development, Immigration Advice and Russian Welfare work made 2004 a very busy year for me. This project continues to support government and non-government services, general and ethno- specific communities, as well as Russian speaking community. Our individual clients come from 75 different countries and with different needs.

Immigration information & Advice Service

Our clients come from different areas of our designated area – Central Coast, Upper Hunter, New England, Mid-North Coast, North Coast, Far North Coast and Central West. For detailed information we refer you to Fig.1 and Fig.2

Fig. 1 – Provision of service to clients by migration agents at the MRC

Agents	No. consultations	No. Phone consultations
L.Tantos	464	945
I.Lupish	300	796
Total	764	1,741

Fig.2 – Clients come from 75 different countries with the top 10 being:

Country of Origin	Type of visa, Issues
Russia	Family – spouse, Domestic Violence, family reunion
China	Student visa, skilled.
Philippines	Family – spouse, Domestic Violence.
Thailand	Spouse, Domestic Violence, temporary business
The Sudan	Refugee/humanitarian
Ukraine	Family – spouse, family reunion.
Serbia	Family reunion, skilled
Zimbabwe	Refugee, family reunion.
Australia	Spouse,
United Kingdom	Spouse, Family reunion, skilled.

Community Development Work

Austcare Refugee Week Celebration – a very successful function at the Newcastle Foreshore was attended by over 200 people. Our newest refugees entertained the crowd with their traditional dancing, while very busy committee members and volunteers were cooking steaks and sausages. This year we paid a special tribute to our hard working volunteers.

Volunteers were presented with a plaque as a token of our appreciation for their dedication and commitment to the refugees of the Hunter.

Information Sessions – four information sessions were presented on Migration Issues to the Filipino community, to the Kempsey Multicultural group and to TAFE students. Six sessions were organized for the Russian speaking group on settlement matters. All sessions were very well attended.

Outreach Work - consultation and information was provided to clients and workers in North Coast – Lismore, Kempsey, Coffs Harbour, as well as in Lake Macquarie, Newcastle and Armidale.

476 telephone consultation were give to the clients from rural and regional areas - Lismore, Coffs Harbour, Grafton, Moree, Orange, Dubbo, Casino, Port Macquarie, Wyaong, Gosford.

Welfare Service for the Russian Speaking community – this service is offered to the Russian speaking communities since July this year on one day a week basis. It provides face-to-face counseling, information, advice and referral. To date 142 occasions of service were given to the Russian speakers. A Russian language Newsletter is published on by-monthly basis, providing settlement information for new arrivals.

The following needs were identified during consultations:

Income	Domestic Violence
Employment	Health
Education	Legal
Qualification recognition	Family issues
Housing	Citizenship

This project also supported the following agencies:	Other Involvements:
Department of Community Services	Facilitate Hunter Refugee Network
Centrelink	Facilitate Multicultural Interagency
Department of Community & Training	Attended a number of meetings, forums
Violence Against Women Project	Attended citizenship ceremonies
Lake Macquarie Interagency	Completed CPD for Migration Registration
L.M.Disaster Welfare committee	Gained Commercial Registration
Kolbe House	Provided clerical support to this project
Lake Macquarie City Council	Attend staff & Management Committee meetings

I would like to thank the staff and the Management committee for their support during the year and especially during my illness.

Irina Lupish – Community Project Officer

2004 ANNUAL REPORT RURAL SUPPORT CSSS WORKER



Rural Support for CSSS Projects

As usual the Rural Support CSSS project is a very busy project that works closely with all the Department of Immigration's (DIMIA) Rural based CSSS projects in northern and western NSW. This year saw several changes with a number new projects coming on line and expansion of a number of existing projects to five day a week projects. Particular attention was given to the new projects and to those where changes in staff meant that a new person had to face the challenges of being

the only migrant worker in their locality. Table 1 shows the frequency of this work through face-to-face contact. While Table 1 indicates a high contact rate with the Hunter Outreach project much of this reflects the ongoing local contact with that project. The most focused regional work was with the establishment of the Orange and New England projects and the support given to helping Dubbo since two workers resigned for personal reasons and Coffs Harbour, where a locum situation was in place, as well as Manning Valley and Wyoming.

Table 1: Face-to-Face Visits to each Rural Based CSSS Project in 2003-2004

Project	Visits
Manning Valley	5
Coffs Harbour	4
Woolgoolga	4
Lismore	3
Hunter Outreach	12
Wyoming	5
Bathurst	3
Dubbo	5
Lightning Ridge	3
Orange	5
New England	7
Afro-Sudanese	2
Total	58

Work with the New England project was higher than with other regional projects since the project is an MRC project New England project. In the 12 months the Rural Support Project has been responsible for assisting in the setting and the Rural Support CSSS project represents the MRC on the advisory committee of the up of the New England project and giving it direction in its development.

The 2004 Rural CSSS Workers Conference was again a successful event for the Rural CSSS project and this project was heavily involved in preparing the agenda, accessing speakers and providing on the day input for the different sessions. As in the previous year the conference was also made open to other CSSS projects from other parts of Australia. Thanks go to DIMIA for its support for the rural conference.

Integrated Service Planning

One of the considerable outcomes of this project has been its work in raising issues that affect the provision of settlement services in rural areas of northern NSW. This has meant that the project has had input into policy development and planning through work with a range of government and non- government services. Table 2 outlines organisations with which planning and development work has taken place. You will notice that included in this Table are the five rural/regional based multicultural networks or interagencies as these act as effective mediums for sharing information and identifying issues and gaps in services that have impacted in the settlement of migrants in regional areas.

Table 2: Planning and Development Work with other agencies

AGENCY -----CONSULTATIONS--AGENCY-----CONSULTATIONS			
DIMIA	8	NICOMS	2
DoCS –state	2	DoCS – regional	3
AMES	8	Hunter Disaster Welfare	2
Health	3	Centrelink	4
Hunter Water	2	NSW Department of Education – School	6
NSW Department of Education TAFE	3	NSW CRC	2
Transcultural Aged Care Service	2	STARTTS	1
Singleton Council	3	Cessnock Council	2
Port Stephens Council	3	Tamworth Council	1
Armidale Council	2	Newcastle Council	5
Muswellbrook Council	2	Mid West Council	2
Dubbo Council	1	Lithgow Council	1
Ethnic Aged Services (Hunter)	6	Hunter CALD Disability Network	7
Hunter Community Council	3	Hunter Refugee Network	4
Central-Far West Multicultural Network	3	Mid-North Coast Multicultural Network	3
North Coast Multicultural Network	3	Central Coast Multicultural Network	4
Newcastle Multicultural Interagency	3	Hunter Rural Multicultural Network	5

Issues raised included lack of understanding by Council's of Migrants and Humanitarian Entrants in their areas, access to interpreting, cross cultural competencies, settlement of migrants in regional areas and the IHSS operation in NSW.

A number of presentations were given by the project on rural issues. The main one of these was to the Local Government Community Services Association's Conference held at Orange, which addressed the mandatory section of Council social plans on people of migrant background.

The general services provided by the project are listed in Table 3. As will be seen 151 individuals received advice and support outside of the work given to the rural based CSSS projects. While numbers of these services were to new arrival migrants the bulk of other individual support was to individuals working for service providers seeking to make contact with new arrivals or to improve access to their services.

Table 3 Services Provided

Face to Face Services with Clients	Telephone Services	Group Work
151	804	130 group sessions– number of group participants 1971

Group reflects a range of work from organising and participating in Migrant interagencies to the provision of training and so on. As can be seen 1971 people participated in this work. Training provided this year included upgrading or introducing services and individuals to improving their cultural sensitivity in working with new arrivals and humanitarian entrants as well as how to access resources like interpreters. Some of this work was undertaken in partnership with other CSSS projects and services like health, aged and general welfare services. This also took place across the rural area that the MRC serves as well as in Newcastle.

As will be seen from previous reports this project has also supported other MRC projects. While support is given to the general work of the MRC particular support has been given to the New England MRC project, the Community Visitor's Scheme in planning and development, and to the Gambling project and the Families First project with support in the provision of training on cultural competencies. The project also supported strongly the Productive Diversity in the Workplace project and its 2004 conference and the value of this project to rural NSW.

Alex Burns

Annual Report 2004

Community Settlement Services Worker - Welfare Outreach

(Funded by Department of Immigration and Multicultural Affairs)



General Client Services

The best news this year was that both CSSS projects, Rural Support and Welfare Support, were refunded for a further three years. This means that the welfare support project will continue to provide ongoing settlement services to recently arrived migrants and humanitarian entrants living in Newcastle and Hunter Region for their immediate and ongoing needs.

I have provided 3 days a week Centre based services at the MRC Newcastle and a regular weekly outreach to Singleton and Cessnock on each alternate Friday. Another outreach service was established at Salamander Bay on every alternate

Thursday to that delivered at Raymond Terrace. The Salamander Bay is a new service and is still developing. The aim of these services is to reach those people where support services are difficult to access or they face additional settlement problems.

In the last six months the CSSS worker has worked with 511 individuals, from 32 different ethnic backgrounds. This is shown in **Table 1**.

Out of these, 164 were new clients and 109 were humanitarian entrants. The greatest number of clients were those aged between 25 and 55, and those who had been in Australia for less than 5 years.

Settlement Information was again the major presenting issue followed by Centrelink enquiries, Bankruptcy and legal (especially regarding Domestic Violence), then overseas pensions from Germany, Italy, Bosnia, Austria and Croatia.

Table 1: Clients and their origins – CSSS Outreach

Country of Origin	No of clients	Country of Origin	No of clients	Country of Origin	No of clients	Country of Origin	No of clients
Malaysia	4	New Zealand	3	Bosnia & Herzegovina	135	Kenya	1
Pakistan	5	India	6	Kosovar	2	Sudan	8
Australia	9	Philippines	8	Fiji	2	Ireland	1
Indonesia	22	Slovenia	2	Greece	13	Germany	6
Serbia & Monte Negro	35	China	7	Turkey	8	Italia	7
Thailand	34	Japan	7	Iraq	1	Romania	5
Croatia	54	Poland	1	Ukraine	2	Netherlands	3
Hungary	6	Pakistan	7	Afghanistan	8	Hong Kong	1
Vietnam	9	Cambodia	1	Chile	2	Bulgaria	2
South Africa	2	Cyprus	2	Sri Lanka	1	Iran	2
Macedonia	69	Russia	4	Egypt	2	Lebanon	1

Group Services

A Cessnock Women's group has been developed and meets once a month at Cessnock Samaritans Neighbourhood Centre. Other groups include the Singleton Multicultural Women's group, Newcastle Akebono Japanese and the Bosnian Group, these are also supported by CSSS worker. **Table 2** shows number of meetings each group has had over the year. It also shows the special events held for the groups.

13 new arrivals from Afghanistan, Indonesia, Vietnam, Iraq, Thailand, the Philippines and Turkey attended a consultation on 21 June in Singleton, held in partnership with TAFE. Most of these students were new arrivals and 11 of them were eligible for the Adult Migrant Education Program.

Group Services - continued

A conversational language classes was also organized for the Singleton client group in partnership with Singleton Neighbourhood Centre.

This takes place in Singleton every Friday and is run by a volunteer teacher , supported as required by this CSSS project.

Together with other MRC case-workers, I also participated in Docs Information Session for the CALD clients.

Table 2: Group Services – CSSS Outreach

Name of Group	No of Meetings	Special Services
Cessnock Multicultural Women's Group	8	Harmony Day Event, Problem Gambling Session, Mental Health, Income Support
Singleton Client Group	7	Harmony Day Event, English Classes consultation at Singleton TAFE, and Conversational language classes at Singleton Neighbourhood Centre, Income Support,
Newcastle Akebono Japanese Group	10	Health, Income support, Families First sessions
Bosnian Community Group	6	DoCS, Settlement Information
Thai Community	2	Migrant Health and Families First Information Sessions

Other work

This year 2 successful Expos were organized and held by the Hunter Rural Multicultural Workers Network which I convened. One was held on 31 October 2003 in Cessnock and more then 40 people attended. The other Multicultural Information Expo was held on 15 October 2004 in Scone. At Scone 30 local services attended in addition to the migrant services.

Over the last year I assisted the CSSS Rural Support worker in 3 Cultural Awareness training with an interpreting role-play and on how to access the T.I.S. service.

I also participated in the development of the Social Planning for people of CALD background with Singleton, Port Stephens and Muswellbrook Councils.

The training I undertook this year was: Community Development Capacity Building; and Disaster Welfare Training.

I also continue to ensure that migrant issues and the profile of migrants in the Hunter are raised through my regular attendance at the Port Stephens Interagency, Cessnock Interagency, Singleton Interagency, Upper Hunter Community Services Interagency, Hunter Rural Multicultural Workers Network, Hunter CALD DOCS Advisory Group meeting, Centrelink Multicultural Forum and Hunter Refugee Support Network.

Finally I like to acknowledge the great support that was given to my clients by the HUB - Samaritans Youth Service through their Brokerage System and St. Vincent De Paul at Mayfield and Cessnock.

Miza Torlakovic

Annual Report 2004

REFUGEE AND HUMANITARIAN ENTRANT WORKER

(Funded by Department of Immigration, Multicultural and Indigenous Affairs)

Since October 2003 I have been assisting refugee new arrivals predominantly Africans with their settlement needs. So far it has been very interesting, challenging as well as being very demanding. My work is to settle refugee arrivals for up to 3 months and then hand them over to the African worker or, maintain them as casework



Achievements

- Successful settlement of over 36 families, in the Newcastle area in 10 months.
- Employment of 40+ refugees at Bartters Enterprises even though there were problems with lack of English language skills and cultural issues.
- Total of 56 families arrived since 2002, 29 families in 2004 and including 7 families with 200 & 204 visas up to and including November. This is shown in **Table 1** below.

Table 1. Shows the Pattern of Sudanese arrivals into the Hunter up to November 2004

	PRE-2002		2002		2003		2004		TOTAL
	MALE	FEMALE	MALE	FEMALE	MALE	FEMALE	MALE	FEMALE	
JANUARY							2	3	5
FEBRUARY	2	1					17	5	25
MARCH	1	1					11	9	22
APRIL			4	2			9	4	19
MAY	2	2			3	3	14	4	24
JUNE					18	10	15	13	56
JULY					0	0	10	8	18
AUGUST			3	2	6	2	8	6	27
SEPT					9	4	13	8	34
OCTOBER			6	3	3	6	7	6	31
NOVEMBER	2	4			3	5	8	17	39
DECEMBER					2	1			3
TOTAL	7	8	13	7	44	31	114	83	303

**** 10 babies were born in the last 2 years to these refugee families

Services provided:

- Airport pick up of new arrivals
- Liaise with Centrelink – making appointments and completing forms for benefits
- Tax File Numbers Application – electronically
- Organising the opening of personal accounts with banks
- Liaising with Department of Housing for bond and advance rent. Completing application forms for the above.
- Searching for the appropriate rental properties.
- Completing application forms for Priority Housing
- Assisting with connecting of phones, water, gas and electricity.
- Liaising with St Vincent De Paul (SVDP) for food vouchers and other welfare needs. Follow-up food voucher while the family awaits their Centrelink payment to come through.
- Shopping for essential items, food, clothing and furniture.
- Liaising with SVDP Sydney for their Household Formation Package and also with the Suppliers re time and date of delivery.

- Referring clients to STARTTS (Service for the Treatment and Rehabilitation of Torture and Trauma Survivors) to assist with counselling and early intervention programmes
- Organising doctor's appointment for initial health assessments
- Organising with Medicare Office the issuing of Medicare cards
- Organising the enrolment of the refugee children with the state and catholic schools.
- Making initial appointments for language assessment with the Adult Migrant English Program (AMEP)
- Liaising with Bartter's Enterprise re employment. We were very successful in employing over 40 people with Bartter's. Many employees come from Sydney, Coffs Harbour and as far away as Perth etc.
- Promoting Sudanese women as hair braiders in local salons. – 2 paid work sessions so far
- Providing transport to clients to and from appointments.

Community Involvement/Events/Information Sessions/Meetings

- In cooperation and partnership with some agencies and MRC staff I have organised and participated in information sessions and community outings in the past 10 months:
- Information and sausage sizzle held at Police Community Youth Club (PCYC) re Bike and Park Safety issues
- Living Skills with Centrelink, Australian Taxation and Department of Housing
- Centrelink information session re Income and estimation for taxation purposes.
- Hunter Refugee Meeting
- Interdenominational Refugee Support meeting
- Hunter Refugee Week – assisting with shopping and transporting of people – liaising with businesses for donation of food for BBQ and Sudanese dance performance
- Weekly bread delivery to Sudanese families.

Problems/Emerging Issues

- Liaising weekly with Real Estates – re problems with clients upkeep of properties etc
- Increasing number of new arrivals and total size of families/number of children
- Transport issues – no drivers license and access to cars – MRC needs “people mover” to help solve these problems
- Significant Cultural differences
- Youth issues
- Limited range of employment opportunities due lack of understanding of the Australian workplace culture and language
- Clients need more assistance than the 3 months agreement period.

Tax Help: About 100 clients were assisted with their tax returns.

Tima 'Oto



Sudanese & African Communities Support Worker

Funded by Department of Immigration & Multicultural & Indigenous Affairs

This project started on 1st July 2004 and during this period the Sudanese & African Communities Support Worker has worked with more than **455** clients and six groups. In the period of four months as the shown in **Table 1**, the African Communities

worker provided **821** occasions of service to **295** people, with an average of around three services per person per month.

476 occasions were delivered face to face and **345** occasions of service were delivered to clients by telephone. Each week around **26** clients received support.

The majority of clients who are assisted by the African Communities worker were from Sudanese ethnic groups and fewer from other African countries, and included men, women, adolescents and children.

Services provided to clients are shown in **Table 2** and concentrated on Consultancy, Referrals, Counselling, Interpreting & Translations and Filling in Forms, General Information and Support and Home and Hospital Visits. Sudanese and African cultural information and consultancy was provided to numerous mainstream community services providers' in the four-month period.

Table 1: CLIENT NEEDS OVER FOUR MONTH PERIOD

Problems & Issues	Face to Face	Telephone	Number of Instances
Multicultural Affairs & Settlement Information	56	35	91
Immigration & Citizenship	8	3	11
Family problems & support	43	18	61
Income support & Finances			
Education & Training	34	27	61
Overseas Qualifications			
Learning English	25	27	52
Accommodation & Housing	25	9	34
Health	40	35	75
Mental Health			
Torture & Trauma	14	11	25
Child Care	33	26	59
Aged Care			
Youth & Sports Issues	29	18	47
Domestic Violence			
Legal			
Police	4	6	10
New Arrivals	61	26	87
Churches & NGO's Supports Issues	24	35	59
Employment	35	31	66
Other Issues	45	38	83
TOTAL	476	345	821

Table 2: CONSULTANCY SERVICES PROVIDED

<u>Services Provided</u>	<u>Number of Instances</u>
Advocacy	27
Referrals	92
Counselling	33
Consultancy	14
Justice of Peace Duties	6
Interpreting & Translations & Filling Forms	91
Hospital Visits	17
General Information & Support & Home Visiting	76
TOTAL	366

Group Work

- ♦ One session was held for newly arrival Sudanese and all sponsors about budgeting, money management and filling in forms.

The African communities worker facilitated the organization of health related sessions and clinics conducted by the Migrant Health Service. These were well attended, with an attendance of approx. 65 clients, the majority Sudanese women, adolescents and children and fewer numbers of men. The clinics were held in July, September and November.

- ♦ The Uniting Church of New Lambton and Migrant Resource Centre, in conjunction with Hunter Community College, organised AMEP English Classes for Sudanese women who could not access childcare for their children at the TAFE classes.. These classes occur at the Uniting Church (Kotara) on Monday and Thursday every week. An average of 18 women attend with 24 children in childcare.
- ♦ The Newcastle Sudanese Dance Group was established on October 4, 2004, with a committee of seven members to organise and manage the dance group. The group consists of an average of 21-32 participants and meets every Monday and Friday at the MRC, for dance practice. Recently, the dance troupe performed at the Austcare & Refugee Week celebrations, at the foreshore on October 23.
- ♦ A Sudanese Women's Sewing Group meets every Monday at the MRC.

Appointments, Meetings and Other Consultancy

Meetings and consultancy, seminars, training and information sessions play a very significant part in the work, in order to provide quality support for those helping the Sudanese. During a four-month period my role as African communities worker, had an average of **127** occasions for, visiting, attending meetings and participating in seminars with different organisations in and around Newcastle. This included the MRC Caseworkers meeting, Refugee week Sub-Committee, Migrant Health Clinics, Sponsors Information Session, Grand Rounds at John Hunter Hospital, Centrelink Managers Meeting, Newcastle Family Court, monthly MRC staff meetings, TAFE information sessions, various Health Information Sessions, United Nations Association Hunter Region, Newcastle Refugee Network, and the Samaritan Foundation "Sudanese Refugee Appeals Group".

Simon Major Pabek



MRC 2004 ...celebrating diversity

SKILLED MIGRANT PLACEMENT PROGRAM

Funded by the Overseas Skills Unit, Department of Education and Training

ANNUAL REPORT - 2004



Key Performance Indicators Dec 2003-June 2004

Full-time employment placements (more than 6 weeks)	23
Part-time employment placements (more than 6 weeks)	17
Work experience placements (140 hours or over)	23

Targets set by the Department of Education and Training in employment for Skilled Migrant Placement Program (SMPP) clients have not only been met but also exceeded by the local program.

This is seen as a culmination of preparing skilled migrants to become job ready, and intervention by the Skilled Migrant Placement Officer (SMPO), in negotiating with employers and matching skills to vacancies. Employment gained by clients has been in all types of jobs including occupations such as bookkeeper, office manager, education counsellor, accountant, occupational therapist, sales assistant, community worker, hairdresser, cleaner, stock assistant, clerical assistant, nursing assistant, industrial sewer and chemical engineering research.

There were many full-time work placements of mainly Sudanese clients at Bartters Chickens in Beresfield. This has been made possible by networking with Mike Anear in Human Resources at Bartters, having established a good contact with him after successfully placing some Muslim Halal slaughterers late last year. I have only referred clients whom I judge are entirely work ready to 'pave the way' for a long-lasting relationship with Bartters. In April, Mike Anear and his recruitment team visited the Centre to meet us and set up procedures for future business, which have proved to be very successful. At the end of October 2004 thirty Sudanese clients have been employed at Bartters.

In spite of these good results, the Department of Education and Training notified in April 2004 that the SMPP Program would no longer be funded beyond 30 June 2004. The justification was given that employment services are seen as a Commonwealth responsibility. This of course leaves a huge gap in tailored assistance to skilled migrants in the Hunter area where commonwealth funded job network offices do not provide such assistance. Many clients have sent letters to their local member and local papers in protest and a story in support of the program was printed in 'The Star' newspaper in early May. However the decision to close the program proved to be irreversible and representatives from the Department of Education and Training visited the Centre in May to go through exit strategies for the program. They supplied a letter to be sent to all active clients and advised on disposal and storage of client files. Outcomes were running at approximately 100% of targets so all grant monies were paid on time.

Twenty-three work experience placements have been sustained for 140 hours to enable them to become outcomes for the SMPP Program. These have included such occupations as librarian, nursing assistant, genetic scientist, hospital attendant, hairdresser, stock assistant, sales assistant, clerical assistant, graphic designer, industrial sewer, engineer and industrial chemist. About one third of work experience placements in 2004 have resulted in paid work for clients. These placements emphasize the pathway to employment that work experience can offer to our clients. It also exposes clients to an experience of workplace culture and local practices in their fields of expertise, giving them that much needed local Australian experience and referees that they can add to their resumes. Without the insured work experience that the SMPP Program offers, migrant jobseekers will be severely disadvantaged after 30 June 2004.

I would like to thank the staff and management committee of the Migrant Resource Centre for their support and positive working relationship over the last four years, which has made my position as Skilled Migrant Placement Officer the most enjoyable role I have ever undertaken.

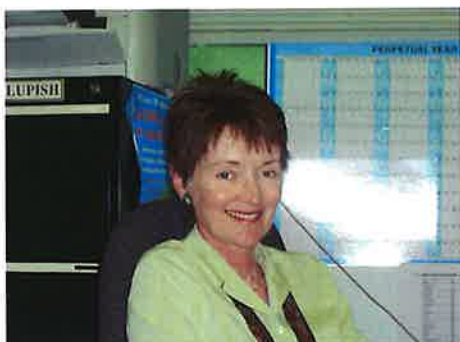
CHRISTINE FOLLETT

PRODUCTIVE DIVERSITY IN THE WORKPLACE PROGRAM

Funded by: NSW Department of Education and Training

ANNUAL REPORT – 2004

1 November 2003 – 30 June 2004



The **Productive Diversity in the Workplace Program** (PDWP) operated in the North West region of NSW for 3 years and for the previous 5 years as the **Rural Information Campaign**.

The objectives of the project – to inform employers of migrant skills and experience, to assist with implementation of productive diversity strategies in the workplace and assistance with recognition processes and training – have been addressed through the life of the Program, with some significant gains for individuals

and businesses. However, the Program was abolished at the end of June, apparently due to financial constraints on NSW and the difficulty of measuring the outcomes of the Program. Despite advice to the contrary from the Department, the showpiece of the workplan – the Diversity Works Conference – went ahead, with the overwhelming support from the MRC staff and management, and was very successful, especially in its development and delivery of the inaugural Diversity Awards.

The conference generated a great deal of extra work which, thanks to Annie Gawn, always was manageable and as a result of her consistently excellent work, was always of the highest possible standard.

Key initiatives:

- Collection of rural and regional “Good News” stories from the four Productive Diversity network areas. Stories have been promoted in the newsletter and added to the webpage.
- Interviewed 17 clients for newsletters. These clients are successfully utilising their overseas acquired skills/qualifications from a range of countries in the following areas:

Country	Gender	Skills	Region
Peru	F	Psychology	Coffs Harbour
Vietnam	F	Interpreting	Newcastle
China	F	Pathology	Lithgow
Philippines	F	Commerce	Newcastle
Denmark	M	Design	Newcastle
Philippines	F	Welfare	Central Coast
Japan	F	Design	Hunter Valley
Egypt	M	Commerce	New England
South Korea	F	Interpreting	Newcastle
Croatia	F	Business	Forster
Philippines	F	Administration	Orange
Iran	M	Business	New England
India	F	Child care	Coffs Harbour
Sudan	F	Business	Central Coast
Croatia	F	Nursing	Newcastle
South Korea	F	Hospitality	Newcastle
Greece	M	Retail	Newcastle

- **Training:** Provided to 25 Managers in NIB and 80 University administration staff on *Workplace Communication and Customer Service*.
- Organised and ran 6 regional network meetings on the themes of *Customer Service in a Diverse Society* and *Partnerships: Job Networks and Migrant Jobseekers*. Total Attendance – 175
- **Harmony Day Partnership:** Breakfast function held in Newcastle on the theme of partnerships, with the theme explored by Newcastle University, Migrant Health and 2 local migrants in their own business.
- **Booklet** – Produced for the Conference, “**Having a go – Leading the Way**”, tells the stories of all the migrants interviewed for the Program and was added to each delegate’s kit. Information about diversity websites was added as a resource.
- **Conference: Diversity Works**, held on May 28 from 12.00 – 6.00pm. Sponsorships were gained from: Lake Macquarie City Council, Small Business Answers Program, Community Relations Commission For a multicultural NSW, IDC Hunter, NSW Department of State and Regional Development (Award sponsors underlined), Centrelink, University of Newcastle, Aurora Training and Professional Services, Newcastle City Council, De Iuliis Wines and Cutcher and Neale. The lunch was held in partnership with *Business Charlestown Incorporated* and the guest speaker was Joss De Iuliis. There were 2 presentations at the Conference, a performance by SPICE and presentations of the 4 inaugural Diversity Awards:

Name of Award	Sponsor	Award	Winner
<i>Diverse Employee</i>	MRC	\$250	Christophe Lecathelinais, Newcastle
<i>Diversity Dividends</i>	NSW DS&RD	\$500	Da Gama Industries, Kurri Kurri
<i>Diversity Management</i>	IDC, Hunter	\$500	Bartter Enterprises, Beresfield
<i>Diversity Works</i>	CRC	\$750+Trophy	Philippe Legall, Bathurst

The Conference Committees all played very important roles in making the day a success and many thanks to them all. 70 delegates attended, with a further 18 also attending the lunch.

- **Presentation** – to TAFE students on productive diversity and changing demographics in the Newcastle region, using statistics available from DIMIA.
- Acquittal report on the Program sent to DET.

This Program has been a very interesting one to work on and I have enjoyed the challenges it has presented. Thank you to all the people in the Centre who have in so many ways made this work so interesting and many thanks to the Management Committee for its on-going support. A final thanks go to Annie Gawn, who has been such a wonderful calm support, efficient troubleshooter and creative artist.

Cathy Johnston
Program Coordinator



ANNUAL REPORT 2004

FILIPINO SOCIAL WORKER

(Funded by the Department of Community Services)

Another very hectic and challenging year for me! Most of my work undertaken during the year continues to be diverse, complex and at times stressful. I have, however terrific support from my colleagues at the Centre and I would like to take this opportunity to thank them.

My work with the Filipino community involves:

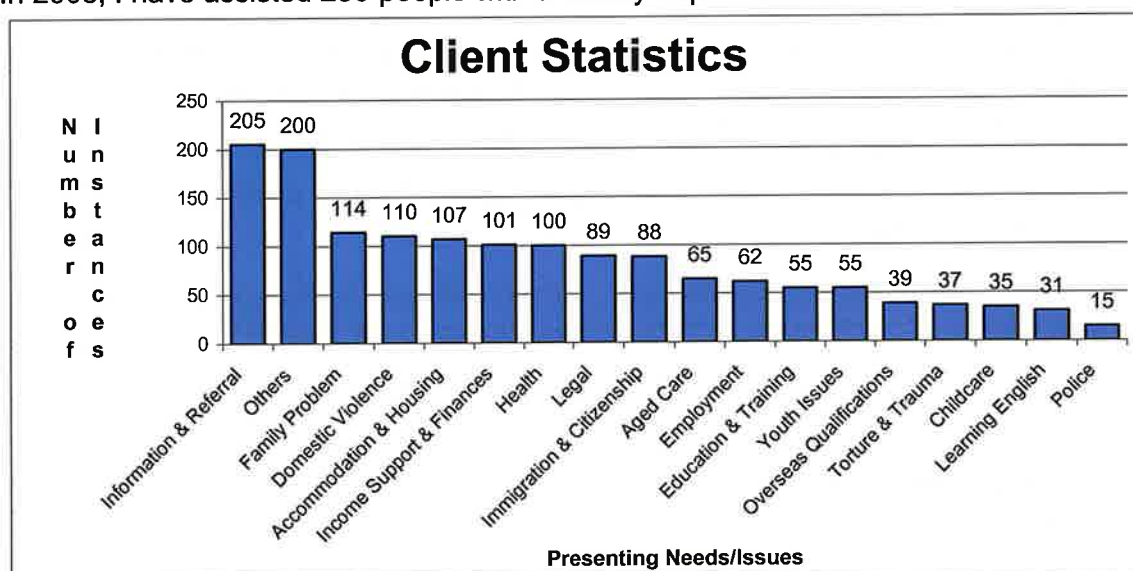
- ◆ Provision of information and referrals
- ◆ Casework management
- ◆ Intervention and advocacy
- ◆ Group work
- ◆ Counselling
- ◆ Liaising with government and non-government departments and mainstream Service providers.

Casework:

Most of my time has been centre-based due to extensive demand of casework services here in Newcastle and its surrounding areas. However, I maintained regular contact with Filipinos in the Mid and Upper Hunter. I also supported Filipino women (via the telephone service) from Taree and the North Coast.

Client Statistics: (Please note that I was working part time earlier in the year while finishing my Bachelor of Social Work degree).

In 2003, I have assisted 250 people with a variety of problems and issues.



As can be seen from the statistics the service of information and referral offered to individual clients forms a significant part of my work. 'Other' come next which include writing supporting letters, JP duties, social/emotional problems, transport difficulties, lost passports & renewals, gambling problems, the need for interpreting, translations of documents, access to belongings, separation & divorce, neighbour disputes, bereavement, cultural and educational information, birthdays, weddings, funerals, infringement notices, filling out forms, the need for referee, statutory declarations, etc.

Likewise, the family, domestic violence, accommodation and housing, income support and finances and health predominate as problem areas.
These issues are inter-related in many cases.

Community Development:

Group information sessions were organised for the Filipino community on topics such as:

- ◆ Arthritis
- ◆ Asthma
- ◆ Injury Prevention
- ◆ Menopause
- ◆ First Aids
- ◆ Diabetes
- ◆ Smoking
- ◆ Relaxation ◆ DIMIA & Centrelink new arrangement for Assurance of Support
- ◆ DOCS Child Protection & Inter-Country Adoption
- ◆ DIMIA's Domestic Violence Policy
- ◆ Family Law Matters (Family Court, Separation & Divorce, Child Contact/Residence, Property Settlement)

Other Activities:

- ◆ I have organised a reference group consisted of seven Filipino women volunteers with the aim of assisting the settlement process of newly-arrived Filipinos in Newcastle and the Hunter Region called, 'Welcome to the Hunter' Volunteers' Training Program. It was a 10 week @ 3 hours per session meetings held at the MRC with each meetings structured around specific topics and incorporated handouts. The training sessions have covered key areas of orientation and the participants were given overview on topics that included welfare, legal, education, health, government departments, ethno-specific services and general information.
- ◆ I have organized Dancing Lessons (Ballroom) for the Filipino Social Group every Friday held at the MRC.
- ◆ I have assisted Filipino students from the University of Newcastle in their research projects.
- ◆ Represented the centre in the Harmony Day Celebration at the Central Coast highlighted with the launched of the booklet, 'Emerging Religions of the Central Coast'.
- ◆ Attended a seminar on Depression- 'Lighting the Way' and the Annual Regional Domestic Violence Forum
- ◆ Attended the following on a regular basis-MRC Staff meetings, MRC Caseworkers meetings, Migrant Forum, CALD

Finally, it has been a rewarding year for me and my thanks go to Violetta and the MRC Management Committee for their continued support to the Filipino Welfare Project.

Pet M.C. Kelly

Filipino Social Worker

2004 Annual Report Multicultural Family Support Project Families First



During the 12-month period a total of 56 families have accessed this service from the Newcastle and Lake Macquarie areas. Of this 22 families received assistance outside of 9 – 5 pm and during the weekends and public holidays.

Of all the 56 families who accessed the service either one or both parents were from culturally and linguistically diverse backgrounds.

During the 12 months period clients from 36 countries were assisted.

Types of issues presented:

(Each family would have one or more of the following issues)

<u>Assistance Provided</u>	<u>No of Clients</u>
Domestic Violence	22
Housing Issues	18
Legal Issues	8
Isolation	26
Child/mother with disability	21
Antenatal/postnatal needs	6
Home Visits	56

Figure 1: Types of issues presented:

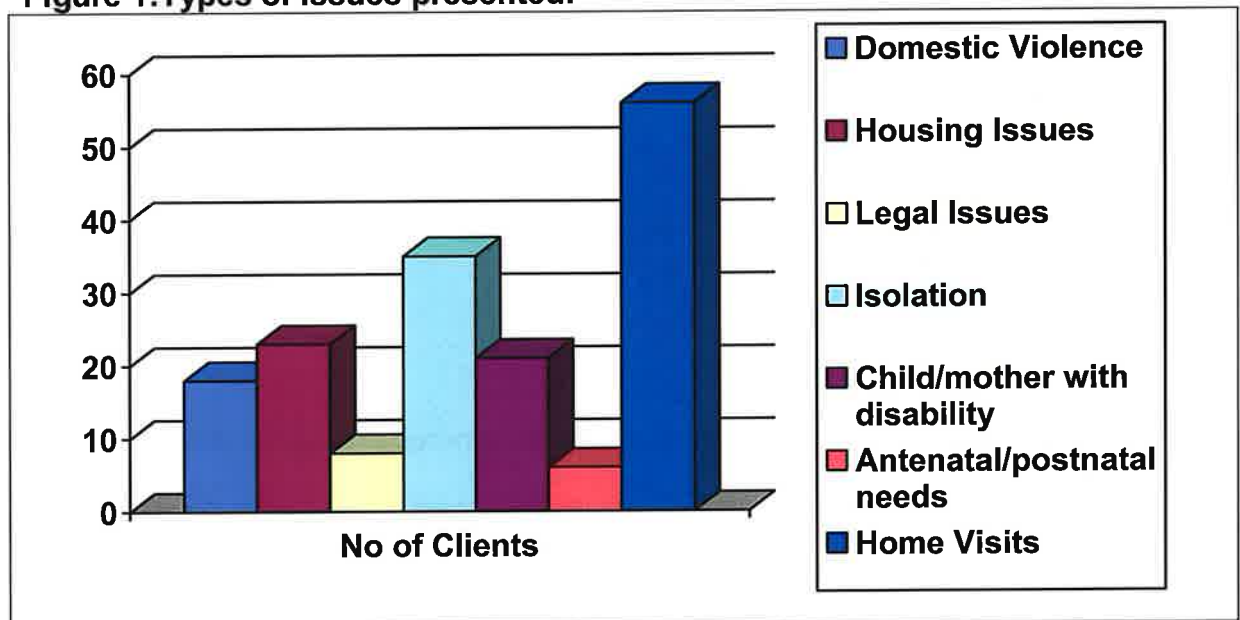
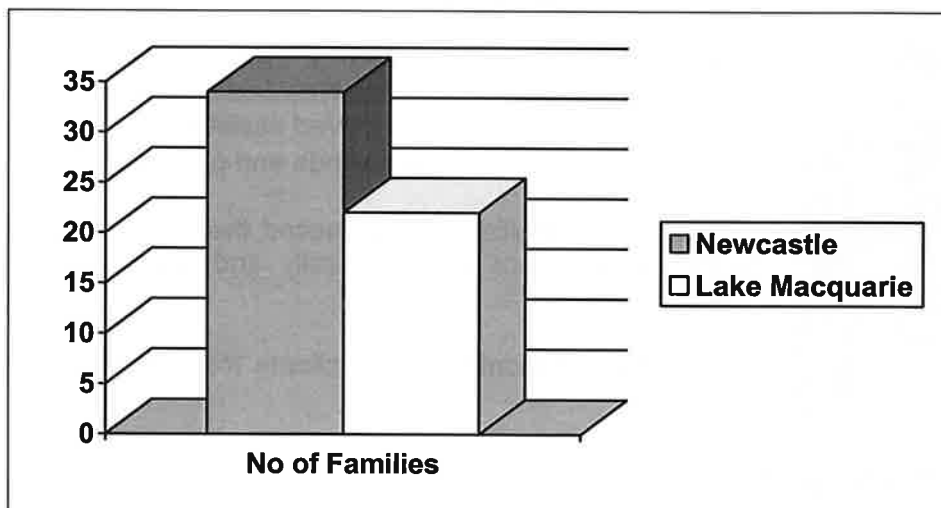


Figure 2: Clients from Newcastle and Lake Macquarie areas:



Networking:

Worked in partnership with Special Education Newcastle University for children with disabilities, Hunter disability services, Migrant Health MOMS Project, Home Start and Refuge Movement.

Worked with Family Support Services, Home Start, Hunter Area Health, Migrant health, Kaleidoscope child health unit, Royal Blind Society, Ethnic Communities Council, Local charities and churches, TAFE, Newcastle and Lake Macquarie Refuges, Family Court, Newcastle Court, Eva's Project, Women's Housing, NewMacq, DOCS, Legal Aid, Waratah Police and Department of Housing in linking clients and working together to provide assistance and support.

Case Management:

Clients accessed the service through self-referral, referrals through other services and from center based referrals. Ongoing case management was provided with support through home visits, referral to other services, and/or accompanying clients to groups such as playgroups and nursing mothers groups.

Administration:

The flyers have been distributed to the relevant services to be given to CALD families.

It has been a very productive and a successful year for this project with many positive outcomes. I would like to thank the Director, staff and the management committee for their support.

Devika Wijewardene

COMMUNITY AGED CARE PACKAGES (CACP)

2004 ANNUAL REPORT

Funded by the Commonwealth Department of Health and Ageing



Sue

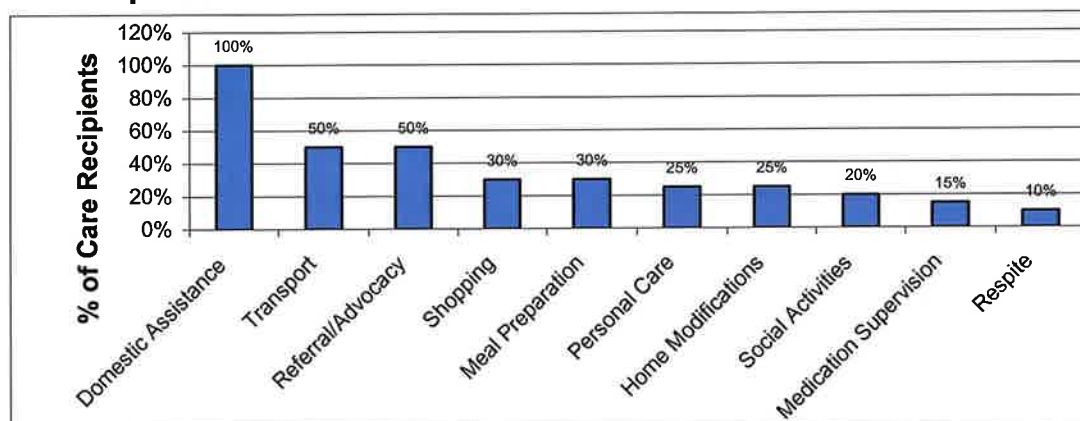
The CACP Project continues to provide a wide range of home based care and assistance to frail aged people from Non English Speaking Background (NESB) who wish to remain living at home as long as possible.



Sulu

All twenty packages are currently full and operating well. In the past year we have had one person move to a nursing home, another voluntarily give up a package and 4 care recipients who have passed away – this represents a turnover rate of 25%.

Services provided



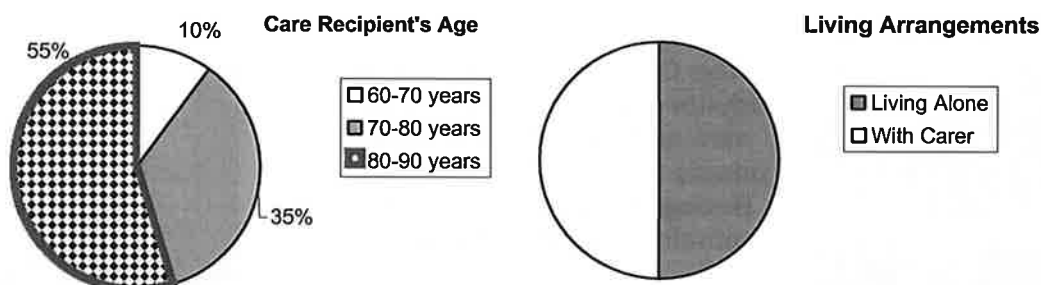
Model of Service Provision

The brokerage model adopted by the MRC continues to be an efficient and effective means of service provision. Having a choice of a variety of providers (5 different ones used in the past year) has enabled us to better meet the cultural and linguistic needs of our care recipients. This is especially crucial for people with dementia.

The Coordination role involved completion of Brokerage and Service Agreements, ongoing monitoring to ensure quality service provision, undertaking initial assessments, organizing and providing orientation to care workers, amending Care Plans in response to changing needs; as well as completing and reconciling: the monthly Subsidy from the Department, care recipient contribution fees and payments to service providers.

Care recipient Profile

15 female and 5 male care recipients representing seven different cultural backgrounds: Italian, Greek, Ukrainian, Polish, Macedonian and Sri Lankan.



Casework management Role

As the Community Aged Care Packages target people who have complex care needs, there is a substantial casework management role for the two part time Coordinators. This involved ongoing monitoring of care recipient's welfare and changing needs as well as the more intensive assistance required as a result of personal or health related crisis situations, such as hospital admissions, changing family circumstances and/or availability of other support mechanisms. The work also involved liaison with and development of a collaborative working relationship with The Aged Care Assessment Team and other allied health/community organizations such as Hospital social workers, community health nurses, podiatrists, Diabetic Education services, Rankin Park Rehabilitation services, Physiotherapist and Occupational Therapists as well as Home Modification services.

New Accountability requirements

The Department is moving towards a more rigorous Accountability Framework for CACP beginning in July this year. This will involve three main areas: Quality Assurance i.e. self - assessment against Community Care Standards and User Rights Guidelines; Data Collection and Financial Reporting.

Funding for additional packages

In recognition of the demographic reality of a rapidly ageing population the Department has significantly increased the number of packages allocated for the next 3 years: 90 in the Hunter this year and 150 for each of the next 3 years. However there are currently 443 people on the waiting list in the Newcastle and Lake Macquarie areas. MRC has applied for 40 packages this year targeting both people from NESB as well as the general population.

Many thanks to everyone at the MRC - both management and staff – for your continued support and assistance- it was much appreciated. Best wishes for a Safe and Happy Holiday Season to everyone.

Sulu (Teleisia) Lolohea & Sue (Slavica) Hristov
CACP Coordinators



ANNUAL REPORT 2003-2004

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE COMMUNITY VISITOR SCHEME

Introduction

The Migrant Resource Centre's Community Visitor Scheme (MRCCVS) completed the 2003-04 year on a successful note. Its Visitors continue to be appreciated by both the residents and the nursing homes in which they operate. Some issues continue

to be a problem, such as the development of more language competent volunteers as well as the challenge of ensuring that the MRCCVS ensures that the Volunteers are developed and nurtured in an ongoing way. A challenge from this year has been to improve our CVS by developing a range of better policies and procedures and to redevelop our publicity material to better inform the wider community of the good work of the project.

Community Visitor Recruitment and Turnover

Table 1 shows the numbers of Community Visitors employed by the MRC Community Visitor Scheme during 2003-04. As the table shows the MRC CVS had some 30 Visitors in the 12 months to the end of June 2004.

During this period 4 Visitors withdrew from the Scheme for various reasons, mostly associated with poor health. The general complaint for some of the Visitors is the personal costs associated with their vehicles. That is, most don't envisage that they will have the ability to buy another car in their lifetime and if the distance is seen to be too great for the costs associated with their role as a Visitor it becomes burdensome.

Visitor recruitment was not high, and with the ongoing difficulties to obtain people with the right second language competency the MRC sought support from other agencies including the Hunter Volunteer Centre and Centrelink. A request to the local migrant communities for volunteer visitors continues. We are also working with other local agencies to look more closely at the issue of Migrants as Volunteers.

Table 1: MRC CVS VISITORS

Active Visitors (at the Beginning of July 2004)	Others (Language currently not required at the beginning of July 2004)	Visitors who withdrew from the Scheme (2003-04)	Total
18	9	4	31

Levels of Activity

The MRC Community Visitor Scheme covers 5 LGAs being Newcastle, Lake Macquarie, Port Stephens, Cessnock and Maitland. The Scheme had residents in 4 of the LGAs. Several of these LGAs have a rural – metropolitan interface. The spread of the MRC CVS is shown in Table 2

Table 2: NURSING HOMES VISITED BY LGA

Local Government Area	Nursing Homes Visited	Currently Not Visiting (2003-4)
<u>Newcastle</u>	Hamilton	
	Irwin Hall	
	Kara	
	Lindsay Gardens	
	Maximillian Kolbe	
	St Josephs	
	Tinonee Gardens	
	Wesleigh	
	Westcott	
	Wallsend	

Continued - Table 2: NURSING HOMES VISITED BY LGA

Local Government Area	Nursing Homes Visited	Currently Not Visiting (2003-4)
<u>Lake Macquarie</u>	Amity	
	Bolton Point (Till Nov. 03)	Bolton Point (Kressville)
	Garden Suburb	
	Hawkins Village	
	C.A. Brown	
	Narla Village	
<u>Port Stephens</u>	Oban (Raymond Terrace Gardens)	
<u>Cessnock</u>	Allendale	
<u>Maitland</u>	Nil	Nil

Orientation and information activities

During the year the Visitors continued to have information sessions to update them on a number of current issues. These sessions included: Occupational Health and Safety; Dementia and working with residents with Dementia, and Relaxation techniques. The Scheme also provided a small number of social activities to maintain group support.

The Coordinator of the MRC's CVS participated in a number of different activities during the year including several Multicultural Service Expos, various networks (interagencies) and Carer's support activities where the CVS was promoted.

Benefits of the scheme

- The MRC CVS provides a very important conduit of communication and a valuable service to Migrant Residents in local nursing homes. The area that the MRC CVS covers is considerable and the numbers of migrants who are residents in Nursing homes dispersed throughout this area is such that many residents do not have relatives living close by, or they are totally isolated.
- The benefits of the Scheme have been acknowledged locally and also include a means by which migrant specific issues are raised with the nursing homes. These issues are raised by the CVS and are acted upon and addressed as a consequence.

However, we are also aware that we need to maintain the profile of the MRC CVS locally, as staff in the nursing homes change and our Visitors can sometimes become "lost" in their system. To this end we are looking at other mechanisms to continue to measure the service satisfaction.

Changes for the future service provision

At this time we don't expect in the near future for our CVS to decline in requests but rather to continue to be a high need. As we resolve our acquisition of new Volunteers we expect the potential of increasing our services to be addressed.

I would like to conclude this report with a note of thanks to Helen Britton of the Department of Health and Aging and Nursing Homes Staff for the support received during this year, but especially our wonderful group of Volunteers who faithfully visit the Residents in the Nursing Homes with a friendly smile and a warm heart.

Johanna Dupree

Multicultural Family Support Worker (28 hrs per week)

Funded by the Department of Community Services.



Tima Oto

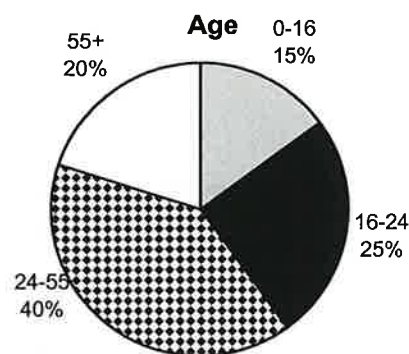
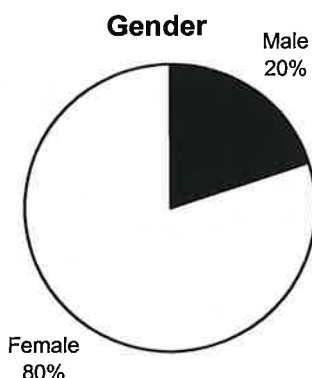
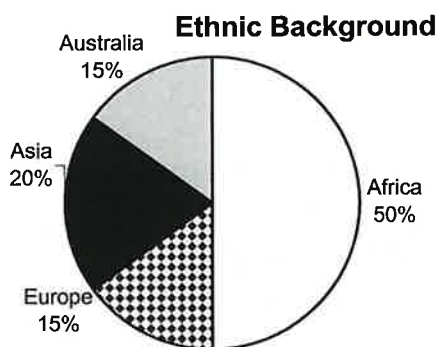


Siri Dwyer

This year, the activities of the Family Support Worker focused on responding to the presenting needs of newer and emerging communities in the Local Government Areas of Newcastle and Lake Macquarie, such as Sudanese, Liberian, Thai and former USSR.

The service provided 1100 occasions of services to 304 people, with an average of 25 per month. Of the client assisted each month of average of 18 were ongoing clients and an average of 5 were new referrals.

Client Profile



Overall, however, client backgrounds have presented the wide range of ethnicity that this Program has been serving in the 12 years of its operation. Up to 36 ethnic backgrounds were represented

COUNTRY	COUNTRY	COUNTRY
Australia	India	Somalia
Austria	Indonesia	Spain
Bosnia	Italy	South Africa
Brazil	Japan	Sudan
China	Macedonia	Tahiti
England	New Zealand	Thailand
Fiji	Panama	Tunisia
Finland	Papua New Guinea	Ukraine
France	Philippines	Uruguay
Germany	Poland	Venezuela
Greece	Russia	Vietnam
Honduras	Samoa	Zimbabwe

CLIENT NEEDS:

Issues presented by clients are shown in the following table.

Problem/Issue	No. of Instances	Problem/Issues	No. of Instances
Family/Parenting	250	Language	100
Housing	60	Employment/Education	30
Domestic Violence	125	* Other	155
Legal	55	Health	125
Income Support	200	TOTAL	1100

SERVICES PROVIDED:

Services provided to families and individuals are as follows:

Services provided	No. of Instances	Service Provided	No. of Instances
General Information	280	General Support	180
Counseling	199	Court Support	21
Advocacy	65	Filling Out Forms	58
Consultancy	40	Home Visits	30
Referrals	114	Agency Visits	40
Mediation	73	TOTAL	1100

GROUP WORK

The Service facilitated meetings of several support groups, on a monthly basis as well as ad hoc meetings convened for special purposes, such as health, legal and migration information.

- the Thai Friendship group was especially active with 10 meetings in the course of the year, with average attendance of 50-60 individuals
- The Japanese Group has also been meeting regularly .
- The Sudanese Women's Support Group is a very new group, focusing on cultural and craft activities and has now met 4 times. It will need much support to help it function. One excellent spin-off has been the take up by local hair salons of the braiding skills of the women

The Service has also worked collaboratively to support activities of other Centre based projects, especially the Refugee Service, which has a major role in the initial and ongoing settlement of families, a task which is proving very challenging.

Tima Oto/ Siri Dwyer.

2004 Annual Report: New England Community Settlement Service Scheme (CSSS) Project

(Funded by the Department of Immigration, Multicultural and Indigenous Affairs)

New Beginnings

This service started in February 2004, initially working from the Centrelink office in Armidale and the relationship forged with Centrelink has been invaluable, especially the professional support provided. Two weeks later the service found a new home at the Regional Extended Family Service (REFS) in Armidale. It is centrally located, near to the TAFE and hospital and is easy for clients to access. The service has also been well supported by REFS and the project uses REFS as a base in Tamworth for the Tamworth Outreach work.

Clients

The service took a few months to establish and the first six months statistics reflected this initial phase, as numbers were slow to start. Now the service is busy working with clients from many backgrounds and with a variety of needs. As can be seen from Table 1, 52 clients have used the service with numbers of these being referred to the MRC's migration agents, who have been an invaluable resource to this service, as it is located in a university town with many students from overseas.

Table 1: First Time Clients - New England Csss Project 2004

Country of Birth	Male	Female	Total Number
Persian	3	4	7
Brunei	0	1	1
Afghanistan	3	0	3
Burma	0	1	1
Sudanese	8	7	15
Indian	3	2	3
Pakistan	0	1	1
Thai	0	3	3
Burma	0	1	1
Zimbabwe	0	1	1
Bangladesh	0	1	1
Japanese	1	1	2
Somalian	0	1	1
Chinese	1	0	1
Fijian	0	1	1
Lebanese	1	0	1
Egyptian	1	0	1
English	1	0	1
Jordanian	1	1	2
Russian	0	2	2
Azerbaijan	0	1	1
Total	22	29	52

Some of these clients have required ongoing support, especially the Sudanese refugees.

Major Issues

The major issues have been education, financial support and health. As the service is new and the Sudanese are also new to the area, services have required a great deal of support and training to become aware of the issues presented and how to deal with them effectively.

Training

Aside of the initial training provided by the MRC Newcastle and Hunter, I was able to attend the 3-day training provided by DIMIA in Sydney and the STARTTS one-day training provided locally in Armidale. The MRC's Rural Support project has provided continued support and training to this project throughout the year.

Community Building and Interagency Co-operation

A major part of the position this year and this has been reflected in the work plan submitted to DIMIA.

Armidale, most of the major service providers in the area have been offered support and information. CSSS attends the local interagency and has supported Centrelink, Armidale and Dumaresq Council (Social Plan), Health, Sanctuary Inc (local Refugee support groups in both Armidale and Inverell are called Sanctuary), International Women's Group, Armidale Women's Refuge, Armidale and District Youth Support Services, Women's Housing, NSWDET and AMEP service providers. I have set up an advisory committee to support the CSSS project and this meets in Armidale and has been well supported by a number of professionals who also work with migrants.

Tamworth, in Tamworth the New England CSSS project has worked extensively with the Women's Health Co-ordinator, Violence Against Women Strategist for the area, TAFE, Centrelink, and Family Support. A multi-cultural committee has been developed and the CSSS has also been instrumental in starting up Tamworth's first migrant women's group. This group has attracted a lot of positive attention from the Tamworth community and allowed the CSSS to be recognised locally, increasing the clientele there. Tamworth had a slower start than Armidale, but the CSSS has now a great network of support from other local services and is being sought as an information source by both service providers and targeted clientele.

Inverell, Recently the CSSS has been investigating the possibility of setting up a regular service in Inverell. Inverell also has an active Sanctuary group and they have their first Sudanese family. The CSSS has been well received locally, where I have attended interagency meetings, worked with the local Sanctuary and advised the local TAFE and schools on our service provision and assistance.

Achievements

The CSSS has made a number of presentations over the course of the year to interagencies in Armidale, Tamworth and Inverell, to Area Health, Violence Against Women Interagency, Sanctuary groups in Armidale and Tamworth, Inverell High Schools, TAFE Tamworth and Armidale, CRC, Youth Services Armidale and District and more.

The service has completed all required milestones and reporting requirements within the set agenda and timeframe of the DIMIA. It has also achieved a positive standing in the community locally with service providers, clientele and migrant community leaders. Happily the service is engaging all migrant groups within the New England community, which is especially important in a regional area where ethnic specific numbers are generally low.

I have been able to encourage other migrant services to be much more involved in the New England area such as Migrant Health, AMEP and the NSWDET Community Information Officer (NESB). I have been instrumental in putting migrant needs on the local agenda and services have responded well to the challenge. Much of this work will be ongoing.

The MRC has supported this outreach extensively on a week-to-week basis, which has been vital to the overall success of the service especially during this initial phase.

Kris Teece

CENTRE USAGE 2004

Immigration Officers Field Visits	STARTTS counseling sessions
Baha'i Community of Newcastle	Bosnian Community of Newcastle
Estonian Community of Newcastle	Filipino Senior Citizens Group
Filipino Women's Group	Greek Macedonian of Newcastle (Pavlos Melas)
Greek Orthodox Holy Apostles	Hungarian Association
Korean Group	Latvian Community of Newcastle
Lettesi Group	Sudanese Women's Craft group
Macedonian Youth Group	Nightingale (sub-group Lettesi)
Newcastle Theosophical Society	Newcastle Japanese Akebano Group
Samoa Women's Group	Samoa Catholic Community Choir
Slovene Association of Newcastle	School of Philippines Studies
Sri Lankan Community	Sudanese Community of Newcastle
Skillmax Group	Vietnamese School
Thai Women's Group	Tamil School
Tongan Community Choir	Tongan Women's Group

In addition the following multicultural groups have been accommodated

Families in Cultural Transition	Hamilton Multicultural Walkers Group
Home and Community Care	International Choir
NESB Gambling Recovery group	Community Refugee Settlement Group
Multicultural Women's Support Group	Newcastle & Hunter Ethnic Choral Society
South Pacific Islander Culture in Education (SPICE) Group	Domestic Violence Torture & Trauma Support Group
Interagency on Migrant Issues	Multicultural Dementia Support

The premises have also been utilized by interagency groups with a migrant focus/interest/sympathy

Amnesty International	Bohemian Outreach Society
Community Options NESB Committee	Centrelink Multicultural Access Forum
DOCS Culturally and Linguistically Diverse (CALD) Committee	Employment Information sessions
Hunter Refugee Network	Hamilton Walkers
Hunter Ethnic Parents Teachers Association Community Languages	Hunter Community Council of Social Service
Hunter NESB Disability Working Party	Pacific Islander Welfare Project Committee
TACS Committee	United Nations Association



MRC 2004 ... celebrating diversity

Other MRC Staff Members



**LULU
TANTOS**
Deputy Director
Migration Agent



**ARLENE
RICHARDS**
Financial
Controller



**MARY
MILEVSKI**
Office Manager



**CARLA
SILVA**
Administration Officer
& Website Manager



**ANNIE
GAWN**
Administration &
Citizenship Support
Officer



**MARK
WHIT**
Administration Officer



**MICHAEL
O'SULLIVAN**
Hunter Parents &
Teachers Community
Language Schools
Project Officer



**JUANITA
LOLI**
Community Welfare
Worker / PIWC

Lupe Fonua

Daniel Follett

Hakim Makem

Kathy Patterson



MRC 2004 ... celebrating diversity

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF
NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

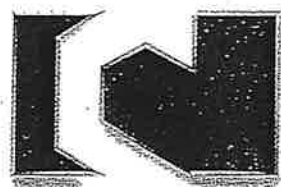
ABN 72 002 898 759

Financial Report

For The Year Ended 30 June 2004



Cutcher & Neale



Cutcher & Neale

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION LIMITED

Financial Report For the Year Ended 30 June 2004

Contents

Directors' Report	1 - 3
Auditors' Report	4
Directors' Declaration	5
Statement of Financial Performance	6
Statement of Financial Position	7
Statement of Cash Flows	8
Notes to the Financial Statements	9 - 19
Compilation Report	20
Detailed Statement of Financial Performance	21 - 22

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 1

DIRECTORS' REPORT

Your Directors present their report on the Company for the financial year ended 30 June 2004.

The names of the Directors in office at any time during or since the end of the year are:

Name	Position		Years Service
Henry Chan	Chairman	Member of Newcastle and Hunter Valley Chinese Association/Financial Advisor	16
Trudy Mills Evers	Director	Retired as Director of Migrant Health Service as of September 2003	
		Dutch Community Representative	19
Bill Samanowsky	Director	Ukrainian Community Representative	15
Ivan Klopčič	Director	President of Slovenian Association	8
Alina Kizewater	Director	President of Polish Association	13
Zoran Vasiljević	Director	Bosnian Community Representative	9
Sania Young	Director	Tartar Community Representative	6
Fr Nicholas Zervas	Director	Greek Community Representative	5
Paul Mather	Director	Fellow of the Institute of Chartered Accountants	3
Mabor Kooc	Director	Sudanese Community (resigned 17/12/03)	2
Andrea Rufo	Director	Italian Community Representative (appointed 19/11/03)	1
Hans Tol	Director	Newcastle Council Representative (resigned 17/3/04)	1
Barbara Gaudry	Director	Newcastle Council Representative (appointed 16/6/04)	1

Directors have been in office since the start of the financial year to the date of this report unless otherwise stated.

Principal Activities

The principal activity of the Company is the provision of welfare and information services.

There were no significant changes in the nature of these activities during the financial year.

Operating Results

The net result of operations from ordinary activities for the year ended 30 June 2004 was a profit of \$43,161.

Review of Operations

Operating profit of \$43,161 was achieved and compares with a profit of \$50,859 achieved in 2003.

The Company operated successfully throughout the period applying grant funds for the purposes for which they were provided. All obligations and conditions of funding have been met.

Significant Changes in State of Affairs

In the opinion of the Directors, there has been no significant change in the state of affairs of the Company for the financial year.

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 2

DIRECTORS' REPORT

After Balance Date Events

No matters or circumstances have arisen since the end of the financial year which significantly affected or may significantly affect the operations of the Company, the results of those operations, or the state of affairs of the Company in future financial years.

Future Developments

No information is included on the likely developments in the operations of the Company and the expected results of those operations.

Environmental Issues

The Company's operations are subject to environmental regulation under the law of the Commonwealth and State. The Directors are not aware of any breaches of the legislation during the financial year which are material in nature.

Meeting of Directors

During the financial period, 11 meetings of Directors were held. Attendances were:

	No. Available	No Attended
Henry Chan	11	9
Trudy Mills Evers	11	8
Bill Samanowsky	11	8
Ivan Klopčič	11	9
Alina Kizewater	11	8
Zoran Vailisjević	11	7
Sania Young	11	9
Fr Nicholas Zervas	11	8
Paul Mather	11	11
Marbor Kooc (resigned 17/12/03)	6	1
Andrea Rufo (appointed 19/11/03)	6	3
Hans Tol (resigned 17/3/04)	8	3
Barbara Gaudry (appointed 16/6/04)	1	1

Indemnifying Officers or Auditor

Clause 83 of the Company's Articles of Association states:-

"Every member of the Management Committee, auditor, secretary and other office for the time being of the Centre shall be indemnified out of the assets of the Centre against any liability arising out of the execution of the duties of his or her office which is incurred by him or her defending any proceedings, whether civil or criminal, in which judgement is given under the Code in which relief is granted to him or her by the Court in respect of any negligence, default, breach of duty or breach of trust".

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

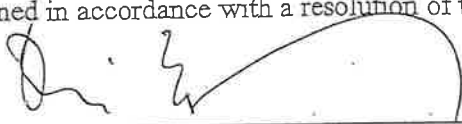
Page 3

DIRECTORS' REPORT

Directors' Emoluments

No Director has received or become entitled to receive, during or since the financial year, a benefit because of a contract made by the Company, with a Director, a firm of which a Director is a Member or an entity in which a Director has a substantial financial interest. This statement excludes a benefit included in the aggregate amount of emoluments received or due and receivable by Directors and shown in the Company's accounts.

Signed in accordance with a resolution of the Board of Directors:



Director



Director

Dated this 21st day of October 2004

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 4

INDEPENDENT AUDIT REPORT
TO THE MEMBERS OF
MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED

Scope

We have audited the financial report of Migrant Resource Centre and Hunter Region Limited for the year ended 30 June 2004 as set out on pages 5 to 19.

The Company's Directors are responsible for the financial report. We have conducted an independent audit of this financial report in order to express an opinion on it to the Members of the Company.

Our audit has been conducted in accordance with Australian Auditing Standards to provide reasonable assurance as to whether the financial report is free of material misstatement. Our procedures included examination, on a test basis, of evidence supporting the amounts and other disclosures in the financial report, and the evaluation of accounting policies and significant accounting estimates. These procedures have been undertaken to form an opinion whether, in all material respects, the financial report is presented fairly in accordance with Accounting Standards in Australia and other mandatory professional reporting requirements and statutory requirements so as to present a view which is consistent with our understanding of the Company's financial position and performance as represented by the results of their operations and their cash flows.

The audit opinion expressed in this report has been formed on the above basis.

Audit Opinion

In our opinion, the financial report of Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and Hunter Region Limited is in accordance with:

- (a) the Corporations Act 2001, including:
 - (i) giving a true and fair view of the Company's financial position as at 30 June 2004 and its performance for the period ended on that date; and
 - (ii) complying with Accounting Standards in Australia and the Corporations Regulations 2001; and
- (b) other mandatory professional reporting requirements

November
Signed at Newcastle on
4 October 2004
First Floor
25 Bolton Street
Newcastle 2300


CUTCHER & NEALE
CHARTERED ACCOUNTANTS
M.J. O'Connor C.A.

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

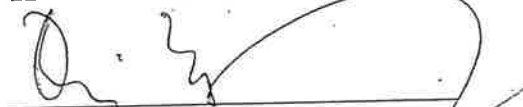
Page 5

DIRECTORS' DECLARATION

The Directors of the Company declare that:

1. the financial statements and notes, as set out on pages 6 to 19 are in accordance with the Corporations Act 2001:
 - (a) comply with Accounting Standards in Australia and the Corporations Regulations 2001; and
 - (b) give a true and fair view of the financial position as at 30 June 2004 and of the performance for the year ended on that date of the Company;
2. in the Directors' opinion, there are reasonable grounds to believe that the Company will be able to pay its debts as and when they become due and payable.

This declaration is made in accordance with a resolution of the Board of Directors.



Director



Director

Dated this 29th day of October 2004.

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 6

STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL PERFORMANCE
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2004

	Note	2004 \$	2003 \$
Revenues from ordinary activities	2	571,368	556,593
Employee benefits expense		(228,149)	(216,436)
Depreciation and amortisation expense	3	(21,155)	(19,727)
Administration expenses		(158,230)	(131,760)
Other expenses from ordinary activities	3	(120,673)	(137,811)
Profit/(loss) from ordinary activities		<u>43,161</u>	<u>50,859</u>
Total change in equity		<u>43,161</u>	<u>50,859</u>

The accompanying notes form part of these financial statements

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 7

STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL POSITION
AS AT 30 JUNE 2004

	Note	2004 \$	2003 \$
CURRENT ASSETS			
Cash assets	5	355,200	311,230
Receivables	6	116,873	76,621
Other	7	10,415	9,471
TOTAL CURRENT ASSETS		<u>482,488</u>	<u>397,322</u>
NON CURRENT ASSETS			
Plant & equipment	8	70,239	78,309
TOTAL NON CURRENT ASSETS		<u>70,239</u>	<u>78,309</u>
TOTAL ASSETS		<u>552,727</u>	<u>475,631</u>
CURRENT LIABILITIES			
Payables	9	83,797	39,378
Provisions	10	137,245	137,336
TOTAL CURRENT LIABILITIES		<u>221,042</u>	<u>176,714</u>
NON CURRENT LIABILITIES			
Provisions	10	22,068	32,461
TOTAL NON CURRENT LIABILITIES		<u>22,068</u>	<u>32,461</u>
TOTAL LIABILITIES		<u>243,110</u>	<u>209,175</u>
NET ASSETS		<u>309,617</u>	<u>266,456</u>
EQUITY			
Retained profits	11	309,617	266,456
TOTAL EQUITY		<u>309,617</u>	<u>266,456</u>

The accompanying notes form part of these financial statements

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 8

STATEMENT OF CASH FLOWS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2004

	Note	2004 \$	2003 \$
CASH FLOW FROM OPERATING ACTIVITIES			
Receipts from customers		549,080	514,061
Payments to creditors and employees		(501,601)	(435,477)
Interest received		9,878	9,440
Net cash provided by (used in) operating activities	18(b)	57,357	88,024
CASH FLOW FROM INVESTING ACTIVITIES			
Purchase of plant & equipment		(25,387)	(27,362)
Proceeds from sale of plant & equipment		12,000	
Net cash provided by (used in) investing activities		(13,387)	(27,362)
Net decrease in cash held		43,970	60,662
Cash at 1 July 2003		311,230	250,568
Cash at 30 June 2004	18(a)	355,200	311,230

The accompanying notes form part of these financial statements

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 9

NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2004

NOTE 1 STATEMENT OF SIGNIFICANT ACCOUNTING POLICIES

The financial report is a general purpose financial report that has been prepared in accordance with Accounting Standards, Urgent Issues Group Consensus Views, other authoritative pronouncements of the Australian Accounting Standards Board and the Corporations Act 2001.

The financial report has also been prepared on an accruals basis and is based on historical costs and does not take into account changing money values or, except where stated, current valuations of non-current assets. Cost is based on the fair values of the consideration given in exchange for assets.

The following is a summary of the material accounting policies adopted by the Company in the preparation of the financial report. The accounting policies have been consistently applied, unless otherwise stated.

(a) Income Tax

The Company is exempt from income tax under Section 50-30 of the Income Tax Assessment Act 1997.

(b) Plant & Equipment

Each class of plant and equipment is carried at cost less, where applicable, any accumulated depreciation.

Plant and Equipment

Plant and equipment are measured on the cost basis.

The carrying amount of plant and equipment is reviewed annually by the Directors to ensure it is not in excess of the recoverable amount from these assets. The recoverable amount is assessed on the basis of the expected net cash flows which will be received from the assets employment and subsequent disposal. The expected net cash flows have not been discounted to their present values in determining recoverable amounts.

Depreciation

The depreciable amount of all fixed assets are depreciated over their estimated useful lives to the Company commencing from the time the asset is held ready for use. Leasehold improvements are depreciated over the estimated useful lives of the improvements.

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 10

NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2004

NOTE 1 STATEMENT OF SIGNIFICANT ACCOUNTING POLICIES (cont'd)

The depreciation rates used for each class of depreciable assets are:

Class of Asset	Average Depreciation rate
Leasehold improvements	14.3 to 20% PC
Equipment	10% to 40% DV
Motor vehicles	22.5% DV

(c) Employee Entitlements

Provision is made for the Company's liability for employee entitlements arising from services rendered by employees to balance date. Employee entitlements expected to be settled within one year together with entitlements arising from wages and salaries and annual leave which will be settled after one year, have been measured at their nominal amount. Other employee entitlements payable later than one year have been measured at the nominal value.

Employee entitlements are calculated for each employee from the first day of employment, so that an accurate charge can be allocated to each grant.

Contributions are made by the Company to employee superannuation funds and are charged as expenses when incurred.

(d) Cash

For the purpose of the statement of cashflows, cash includes:

- cash on hand and at call deposits with banks or financial institutions, net of bank overdrafts; and
- investments in money market instruments maturing with less than 14 days to maturity.

(e) Revenue

Revenue from the rendering of a service is recognised upon the delivery of the service to the customers.

Interest revenue is recognised on a proportional basis taking into account the interest rates applicable to the financial assets.

All revenue is stated net of the amount of goods and services tax (GST).

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED
ABN 72 002 898 759
(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 11

NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2004

NOTE 1 STATEMENT OF SIGNIFICANT ACCOUNTING POLICIES (cont'd)

(f) Goods and Services Tax (GST)

Revenues, expenses and assets are recognised net of the amount of GST, except where the amount of GST incurred is not recoverable from the Australian Tax Office. In these circumstances the GST is recognised as part of the cost of acquisition of the asset or as part of an item of the expense. Receivables and payables in the statement of financial position are shown inclusive of GST.

(g) Comparative Figures

Where required by Accounting Standards comparative figures have been adjusted to conform with changes in presentation for the current financial year.

(h) Administration Fees

Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and Hunter Region Limited charge each grant as set out in Note 1 (i), an administration fee at commercial rates. Where the grant is unable to remit payment to Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and Hunter Region Limited this amount is shown as a bad debt or provision for doubtful debts where applicable.

(i) Affiliated Grant Activities

Affiliated grant activities of the Company have been excluded from the financial report. These activities are:

- Community Visitors Scheme
- Family Support
- Filipino Welfare Project
- Community Settlement Service Scheme I
- Community Settlement Service Scheme II
- Special Migrant Placement Officer
- Rural Information Campaign
- Casino
- Immigration Advice and Application Assistance Scheme
- Community Aged Care Packages
- Refugee Housing
- Families First Cald Worker

(j) Grant Contribution

Amounts received from affiliated grants that are unable to pay the allocated administration charge and long service leave contribution at balance date are written off. This amount is raised as a grant contribution in Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and Hunter Region Limited.

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 12

**NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2004**

NOTE 1 STATEMENT OF SIGNIFICANT ACCOUNTING POLICIES (cont'd)

(k) Unexpended Grant Monies

The unexpended grant monies (Note 9) shown in the accounts will be brought to account over the term of the contracts or repaid to the funding body as set out in the funding agreements.

(l) Adoption of Australian Equivalents to International Financial Reporting Standards

Australia is currently preparing for the introduction of International Financial Reporting Standards (IFRS) effective for financial years commencing 1 January 2005. This requires the production of accounting data for future comparative purposes at the beginning of the next financial year.

The Company's management, along with its auditors, are assessing the significance of these changes and preparing for their implementation.

	2004 \$	2003 \$
NOTE 2 REVENUE		
Operating activities		
- Grant funds	289,175	300,068
- Administration fee received	254,435	204,572
- Interest received – other persons	9,878	9,440
- Other revenue	5,880	42,513
Total Revenue	<u>559,368</u>	<u>556,593</u>
Non-Operating activities		
- Proceeds on disposal of plant & equipment	12,000	
	<u>571,368</u>	<u>556,593</u>

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 13

NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2004

NOTE 3 PROFIT FROM ORDINARY ACTIVITIES

Profit from ordinary activities has been determined after:

(a) Expenses

Depreciation of non current assets
- plant and equipment

	2004	2003
	\$	\$

	21,155	17,005
--	--------	--------

Amortisation of non current asset
- leasehold improvements

	2,668	2,722
--	-------	-------

Remuneration of auditor
- audit

	5,766	6,389
--	-------	-------

Rental expense on operating lease
- minimum lease payments

	72,428	76,965
--	--------	--------

Bad and doubtful debts
- grant debtors

	30,177	54,457
--	--------	--------

Administration cost

	12,302	
	120,673	137,811

(a) Revenue and Net Gains

Net loss on disposal of plant and equipment

302

NOTE 4 DIRECTORS' REMUNERATION

(a) Directors Remuneration

Income paid or payable to all Directors
of the Company

Number of Company Directors whose
income from the Company was within
the following band:

\$0 - \$9,999

The names of Directors who have held office
during the financial year are:

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 14

NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2004

	2004	2003
	\$	\$

NOTE 4 DIRECTORS' REMUNERATION (cont'd)

Henry Chan	Trudy Mills Evers
Bill Samanowsky	Ivan Klopčic
Alina Kizewater	Zoran Valisjevic
Sania Young	Barbara Gaudry
Fr Nicholas Zervas	Andrea Rufo
Paul Mather	Mabor Kooc
Cr Hans Tol	

NOTE 5 CASH

Cash at bank	189,825	153,816
Deposits at call	165,375	157,414
	355,200	311,230

NOTE 6 RECEIVABLES

Trade debtors	73,409	97,486
Provision for loss on administration fees	(11,236)	(20,865)
	62,173	76,621
Other debtors	54,700	-
	116,873	76,621

NOTE 7 OTHER ASSETS

Prepayments	10,415	9,471

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 15

NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2004

NOTE 8 PLANT & EQUIPMENT

	2004 \$	2003 \$
Leasehold improvements – at cost	36,532	36,532
Less: accumulated amortisation	(33,138)	(30,470)
	<u>3,394</u>	<u>6,062</u>
Equipment – at cost	122,219	122,219
Less: accumulated depreciation	(104,128)	(97,961)
	<u>18,091</u>	<u>24,258</u>
Motor vehicles – at cost	65,663	64,213
Less: accumulated depreciation	(16,909)	(16,224)
	<u>48,754</u>	<u>47,989</u>
Total Plant & Equipment	<u>70,239</u>	<u>78,309</u>

Movements in carrying amounts

Movements in the carrying amount for each class of plant and equipment between the beginning and the end of the current financial year.

	Leasehold Improvements	Equipment	Motor Vehicles	Total
Balance at the beginning of the year	6,062	24,258	47,989	78,309
Additions	-	-	25,387	25,387
Disposals	-	-	(12,302)	(12,302)
Depreciation and amortisation expense	(2,668)	(6,167)	(12,320)	(21,155)
Carrying amount at the end of the year	<u>3,394</u>	<u>18,091</u>	<u>48,754</u>	<u>70,239</u>

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 16

NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2004

	2004 \$	2003 \$
NOTE 9 PAYABLES		
Trade creditors	38,909	22,332
Grant Funds Carried Forward – Core Grant	44,888	17,046
	83,797	39,378
NOTE 10 PROVISIONS		
CURRENT		
Employee entitlements	137,245	137,336
NON CURRENT		
Employee entitlements	22,068	32,461
(a) Aggregate employee entitlement liability	159,313	169,797
(b) Number of employees at year end	20	18
NOTE 11 RETAINED PROFITS		
Retained profits at the beginning of the financial year	266,456	215,597
Net profit/(loss) attributable to members of the Company	43,161	50,859
Retained profits at the end of the financial year	309,617	266,456

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 17

NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2004

2004	2003
\$	\$

NOTE 12 COMPANY DETAILS

The registered office and principal place of business is:

8 Chaucer Street
HAMILTON NSW 2303

NOTE 13 CAPITAL & LEASING COMMITMENTS

(a) Operating Lease Commitments

Non-cancellable operating leases contracted
for but not capitalised in the financial report

Payable		
- not longer than 1 year	63,097	90,978
- longer than 1 year but not longer than 5 years	-	159,212
	63,097	250,190

The property lease is a non-cancellable lease with a five-year term, with rent payable monthly in advance. Contingent rental provisions within the lease agreement require the minimum lease payments shall be increased by CPI. An option exists to renew the lease at the end of the five-year term for an additional term of five years.

NOTE 14 MEMBERS' GUARANTEE

The Company is limited by guarantee. If the Company is wound up, the articles of the Company state that each Member is required to contribute a maximum of \$10 each towards meeting any outstanding obligations of the Company. At 30 June 2004 the number of Members was 69 (2003 - 69)

NOTE 15 SEGMENT REPORTING

The Company operates in the services industry wholly within Australia.

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 18

NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2004

NOTE 16 FINANCIAL INSTRUMENT

(a) *Interest Rate Risk*

The financial assets and liabilities subject to interest rate risk are:

Bank Accounts

The Company's bank accounts earn interest at the market variable rate.

Short Term Deposits

The Company's term deposit earns interest at a rate of 4.45%.

All other financial assets and financial liabilities are not subject to interest rate risk as they are non-interest bearing.

(b) *Credit Risk*

The credit risk on financial assets of the Company which have been recognised on the balance sheet, is the carrying amount net of any provision for doubtful debts.

(c) *Net Fair Value of Financial Assets and Liabilities*

The Company's financial assets and liabilities included in the balance sheet are carried at amounts that approximate net fair value.

2004	2003
\$	\$

NOTE 17 STATEMENT OF CASH FLOWS

(a) Reconciliation of Cash

Cash at the end of the financial year as shown in the statement of cashflows is reconciled to the related items in the statement of financial position as follows:

Cash at bank	189,825	153,816
Cash on deposit	165,375	157,414
	355,200	311,230

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 19

NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2004

	2004 \$	2003 \$
NOTE 17 STATEMENT OF CASH FLOWS (cont'd)		
(b) Reconciliation of cash flow from operations with profit from ordinary activities		
Profit/(loss) from ordinary activities	43,161	50,859
Non-cash flows in profit from ordinary activities:		
Depreciation and amortisation	21,155	19,727
(Profit) / Loss on sale of fixed assets	302	
Changes in assets and liabilities:		
(Increase) / decrease in receivables	(40,252)	(33,092)
(Increase) / decrease in prepayments	(944)	(1,552)
Increase / (decrease) in trade creditors and accruals	16,577	18,861
Increase / (decrease) in provisions	(10,484)	16,175
Increase / (decrease) in grant funds carried forward	27,842	17,046
Cash flow from operations	57,357	88,024

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 20

COMPILATION REPORT
TO MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE
AND HUNTER REGION LIMITED

Scope

On the basis of information provided by the Directors of Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and Hunter Region Limited, we have compiled in accordance with APS 9 'Statement on Compilation of Financial Reports' the following:

1) Detailed Statement of Financial Performance

of Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and Hunter Region Limited for the period ended 30 June 2004.

The specific purpose for which the above detailed financial reports have been prepared is to provide private information to the Directors and Members. Accounting Standards and UIG Consensus Views have been adopted in the preparation of the above detailed financial reports.

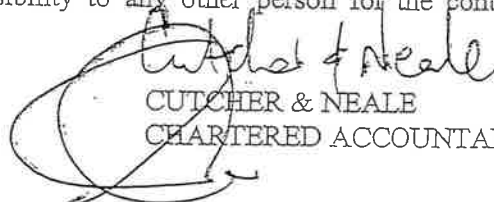
The Directors are solely responsible for the information contained in the above detailed financial reports and have determined that the accounting policies used are consistent with the financial reporting requirements of Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and Hunter Region Limited constitution and are appropriate to meet the needs of the Directors and Members of the Company.

Our procedures use accounting expertise to collect, classify and summarise the financial information, which the Directors have provided into the detailed financial reports. Our statutory audit procedures do not include verification or validation procedures over allocations within the above detailed financial reports and accordingly no assurance or opinion is expressed as to their accuracy.

To the extent permitted by law, we do not accept liability for any loss or damage which any person, other than the Company, may suffer arising from any negligence on our part. No person should rely on the above detailed financial reports without having an audit or review conducted upon them.

The above detailed financial reports were prepared for the benefit of the Directors and Members of Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and Hunter Region Limited and the purpose identified above. We do not accept responsibility to any other person for the contents of the special purpose financial report.

1st Floor
25 Bolton Street
NEWCASTLE


CUTCHER & NEALE
CHARTERED ACCOUNTANTS

M. J. O'Connor
Partner

21 October 2004

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED (A COMPANY LIMITED BY GUARANTEE)
ABN 72 002 898 759

Page 21

STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL PERFORMANCE
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2004

	2004	2003
<u>Income</u>		
Administration Fees	254,435	204,572
Donations received	127	1,013
Grants received	317,017	317,114
Transfer from unexpended funds	17,046	-
Less Carried forward to next year	(44,888)	(17,046)
Interest received	9,878	9,440
Interpreting fee	136	3,100
Membership Fees	76	162
MS direct migration	202	1,040
Photocopying	635	542
Contribution to expenses	2,935	36,154
Sundry	1,769	503
Total Income	559,368	556,594
<u>Expenses</u>		
Administration fees	-	1,696
Advertising	2,484	2,158
Audit and accounting fees	5,766	6,389
Bank charges	543	384
Carer week expenses	4,016	-
Catering, function	4,220	2,963
Cleaning	7,518	7,449
Computer expenses	11,525	10,644
Consulting	-	480
Depreciation and amortisation	21,155	19,727
Donations	200	130
Electricity	5,481	4,907
Fringe benefits tax	1,211	-
Grant Contribution	39,806	65,129
Insurance	8,693	7,847
Immigration booklets	-	820
Interpreting fees	1,185	922
Library	-	1,421
Licence fees	548	399
Loss on sale	302	-
Photocopier expenses	9,570	10,114

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED (A COMPANY LIMITED BY GUARANTEE)
ABN 72 002 898 759

Page 22

STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL PERFORMANCE
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2004

	2004	2003
Office furniture	3,816	-
Office supplies	1,229	2,326
Postage	8,576	7,247
Printing and Stationery	8,481	6,737
Provision for loss on administration fees	(9,629)	(10,672)
Rent	72,428	76,965
Rent outgoings	16,308	13,068
Repairs and Maintenance	1,322	335
Security	835	657
Seminar and training	2,878	1,363
Staff amenities	4,862	2,732
Subscriptions and membership	530	328
Telephone	33,074	26,950
Travel	2,033	1,165
Wages	228,149	216,436
Workers Compensation	17,092	16,519
Total Expenses	<u><u>516,207</u></u>	<u><u>505,735</u></u>
Operating profit/(loss)	<u><u>43,161</u></u>	<u><u>50,859</u></u>